

DIGITAL INFORMATION LITERACY COMPETENCIES AMONG POST GRADUATE STUDENTS OF NATIONAL COLLEGE, TIRUCHIRAPPALLI: A STUDY

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Tiruchirappalli*

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In partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the
degree of

MASTER OF LIBRARY AND INFORMATION SCIENCE

Submitted by
SIVAKUMAR C
[Reg. No. 221212014]

Under the guidance of
Dr. S. YESAN M.L.I.Sc., PGDLAN., BCS., Ph.D., NET.,
Assistant Professor, DLIS



PG & Research Department of Library and Information Science Bishop Heber College (Autonomous)

(Nationally reaccredited at **A++** Grade by NAAC with a CGPA of 3.69 out of 4)
(Ranked **34th** at National Level by MHRD through NIRF 2023)
(Recognized by UGC as “College of Excellence”)

Tiruchirappalli - 620017

March 2024



Dr. S. YESAN M.L.I.Sc., PGDLAN., BCS., Ph. D., NET.,
Assistant Professor,

PG & Research Department of Library and Information Science
Bishop Heber College (Autonomous)
(Nationally recredited at A++ Grade by NAAC with a CGPA of 3.69 out of 4)
(Ranked 34th at National Level by MHRD through NIRF 2023)
(Recognized by UGC as “College of Excellence”)
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PG & Research Department of Library and Information Science
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The Viva-Voce Examination for the candidate **C. Sivakumar (221212014)** was held at the PG & Research Department of Library and Information Science, Bishop Heber College (Autonomous), Tiruchirappalli on _____.

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I hereby declare that the work presented in this dissertation is the original work done by me under the guidance of **Dr. S. Yesan, Assistant Professor, PG & Research Department of Library and Information Science**, Bishop Heber College (Autonomous), Tiruchirappalli and has not been included in any other thesis or dissertation submitted for any other degree.

Name of the Candidate : **C. SIVAKUMAR**

Register Number : **221212014**

Academic Year : **2023 – 2024**

Signature of the Candidate

(C. SIVAKUMAR)

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Jesse R. Sparks, Irvin R. Katz, Penny M. Beile.
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Recommendations for Next-Generation
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2016

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Osagie Oseghale. "Digital information literacy
skills and use of electronic resources by
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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

INTRODUCTION

In this modern day, information attainment shows the range of competency of teachers, researchers, and students in any education degree by reaching the new learning context. Information may be easily obtained about anything at anytime and anywhere by employing information technologies like email, the internet, software, and other e-resources. This information can then be used to create new knowledge. Proficiency in digital literacy is vital to achieve fulfilment in the modern world. Digital information literacy skills are arguably just as important in today's culture as basic study, storytelling, and reasoning ability (Haider & Sundin, 2022).

Digital sources have produced a variety of information sources, including text, video, audio, and more, and they have made data accessible anywhere, at any time. This sets digital literacy apart from conventional literacy. The ability to read words and the outside world is a learning skill.

The word Information Literacy is first appeared in the year of 1974 and it was reported by **Paul G. Zurkowski** (Barman, 2022). Information literacy is more than just a skill; it is a holistic approach to acquiring, evaluating, and applying information in various contexts. It empowers individuals to critically assess the credibility, relevance, and reliability of information sources, enabling them to make informed decisions and contribute meaningfully to society. In essence, information literacy is the key to unlocking the full potential of the vast resources available in the information landscape. Digital literacy is the ability to comprehend, evaluate, and apply knowledge from a range of sources that we may access through computer devices.

Digital information literacy encompasses a multifaceted set of skills, including the ability to evaluate the reliability of online sources, navigate digital platforms with discernment, and leverage technology to gather, synthesize, and communicate information effectively. It extends beyond traditional literacy to include proficiency in utilizing digital tools, understanding algorithms, and being aware of the ethical implications surrounding digital information consumption and creation.

1.1. Digital Information Literacy

The word information is derived from the Latin word *informare*, which means concept or idea. The word *literate* in Latin means learned or lettered. The conventional definition of the term 'literacy' was the ability to read and write at a basic level and sign a document.

Digital Information Literacy has been defined by several thinkers as the abilities possessed by individuals to identify, access, integrate, evaluate, analyse, organise, create and communicate information from digital resources of information. The focus has been laid on the ethical use of digital resources of information and the adoption of digital information literacy in their social lives. In the present study digital information literacy refers to the proficiency of the respondents in accessing, evaluating and ethically using digital resources of information. It also refers to the adoption of digital information literacy skills in their social lives.

1.2. Importance of Digital Information Literacy

Access to Information: Digital information literacy allows people to effectively access the vast amount of information available online. It ensures that people can find relevant and reliable information to meet their needs, whether they are conducting academic research, working professionally, or enriching their personal lives.

Critical Thinking: In the digital age, misinformation and fake news are common. Digital information literacy fosters critical thinking skills, enabling people to assess the credibility, reliability, and accuracy of information. This is critical for making informed decisions and preventing the spread of incorrect information.

Academic Success: In educational settings, students require digital information literacy skills to conduct research, evaluate sources, and effectively present information. It is critical for academic success and assists students in becoming informed consumers and creators of knowledge.

Professional Development: In the workplace, digital information literacy is an essential skill. Employees who can effectively use digital tools, analyse data, and keep up with industry trends are more likely to advance in their careers. Digital information literacy promotes professional development and adaptability in a rapidly changing job market.

Global Connectivity: The digital world allows people to connect from all over the world. Individuals with digital information literacy can engage with a variety of perspectives, cultures, and information from all over the world. It raises global awareness and understanding.

Privacy and Security: Understanding digital information literacy requires knowledge of online privacy and security. It teaches people how to protect their personal information, stay aware of digital threats, and practice safe online habits.

1.3. Components of Digital Information Literacy

Information Retrieval: The skill to effectively search for and locate information using digital tools and resources such as search engines, databases, and online libraries.

Critical Evaluation: The ability to critically assess the credibility, reliability, and relevance of digital information. This involves considering the source, checking for bias, and evaluating the quality of evidence.

Digital Citizenship: Understanding the ethical and legal aspects of using digital information. This includes respecting copyright, adhering to privacy norms, and engaging in responsible online behaviour.

Digital Communication: Proficiency in expressing ideas and information through digital means, including writing, creating multimedia content, and collaborating online.

Data Literacy: Understanding and interpreting data effectively. This includes the ability to analyse and draw meaningful conclusions from data sets and visualizations.

Cybersecurity Awareness: Being aware of online security threats and practising safe online behaviour to protect personal information and digital assets.

Adaptability: The capacity to adapt to new digital tools and technologies as they emerge, staying abreast of the latest developments in the digital landscape.

Problem-Solving: Using digital tools and information to solve problems and make informed decisions.

1.4. Digital Information Literacy in College Library

Students: The library is heavily used by college students for research and academic purposes. They are equipped with the skills necessary to effectively search for, evaluate, and use digital resources. Databases, online journals, e-books, and other electronic materials are critical for academic success.

Faculty and Researchers: College faculty and researchers use the library to access scholarly resources, conduct research, and stay current on topics in their fields. They can use digital information literacy to navigate digital databases, evaluate online sources critically, and use technology for academic and research purposes.

Lifelong Learning: In an ever-changing world, the ability to learn and adapt is essential. Digital information literacy promotes lifelong learning by equipping individuals with the ability to navigate new technologies, acquire new information, and remain relevant in an ever-changing digital environment.

Empowerment: Digital information literacy allows people to actively participate in the digital society. It lowers the risk of manipulation or exploitation by ensuring that people can critically engage with digital content, express themselves online, and make meaningful contributions to digital communities.

CHAPTER 2
REVIEW OF
LITERATURE

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

2. INTRODUCTION:

This chapter deals with the relevant review of literature. The analysis of review of literature is the key focus of any research. It enables one to be aware of the past and current trends in any particular research. In this study, I have used different search strategies and Academic social networking sites for the purpose to collect reviews of literature related to this project title “Digital Information Literacy competencies among Post Graduate Students of National College, Tiruchirappalli: A Study”.

2.1. INFORMATION LITERACY

Lee, T., & Lee, B.-K. (2020) discussed about the effects of information literacy on trust in government websites. This study empirically investigated the effects of individual characteristics, specifically perceived information literacy and perceived information overload, on users' opinions of the value and reliability of a government website. The author in this study offered a more comprehensive knowledge of the adoption behaviour of e-government, enhanced by the specifics of citizen involvement variables. This study also identified important practical implications for the development of effective e-government policies.

Laspinas, M. (2019) studied the access and retrieval of electronic resources in academic libraries, the author's idea was to assess how easy it was to access and retrieve Academic Libraries' electronic resources in Cebu City. The study specifically aimed to determine the available electronic resources, the reason why library patrons used them, and the issues that they ran across. The descriptive approach of research was used in this study. This approach was intended to collect factual and empirical data regarding the use of electronic resources. In addition, the researcher employed the observational approach to pinpoint the issues that the consumers were facing. The results of this investigation showed that the university library subscribes to two electronic journals: Educator's Reference Complete and InfoTrac Custom 100. Additionally, it was discovered that the users' primary uses of electronic resources were for projects, research, and teaching.

Leaning, M. (2019) discussed the topic of an approach to digital literacy through the integration of media and information literacy. This article examined the histories and practices of two of these skills, media literacy and information literacy, and it suggests a path forward for digital literacy. Three primary sections make up the article. Information literacy's history was covered

in Section One. Several seminal writings and declarations chart the progressive evolution and enhancement of information literacy. Media literacy was the subject of section two. Three main strands of media literacy instruction had been identified, each employing distinct methods and pursuing varying political objectives. The three methods were still distinguishable, and this framework helps to explain the variations in media education practices in the present day. The last section of this study makes the case that although both media and information literacy have many benefits and also, they had some drawbacks in this study. For example, media literacy does not completely address the nature of digital technology or how it enables users to take up new communication practices, whereas information literacy does not have the same level of development in terms of a critical approach as media literacy.

Becker, W. (2018) illustrated digital information literacy in his study *Information Literacy in the Digital Age: Myths and Principles of Digital Literacy*. Since we are now living in the Digital Age, it was also necessary to talk about how information literacy is changing. More specifically, given that an increasing number of information demands can only be satisfied by using digital resources, librarians are now expected to carry out the duties of digital literacy in addition to traditional methods of information literacy. By looking at the various components of the two literacies, debunking common misconceptions about them, and outlining some fundamental ideas for teaching and acquiring information literacy in the digital age, this study contributes to the conversation. The author contributed this study to the conversation, by looking at the various components of the two literacies, debunking common misconceptions about them, and outlining some fundamental ideas for teaching and acquiring information literacy in the digital age.

2.2. DIGITAL INFORMATION LITERACY

Lestariani, N. (2023) studied the influence of digital information literacy on student learning outcomes, attempts to examine how digital information literacy affects learning results. This study uses an ex post facto methodology and a quantitative approach. 42 students from Tarbiyah and the Teacher Training Faculty of Mataram State Islamic University's Biology Science Education Department who were enrolled in the Animal Ecology course during the 2022–2023 academic year participated in this study. Tests are used to measure learning outcomes, while questionnaires are used to gather data on digital information literacy. With the aid of SPSS version 22, an elementary regression test was used to assess the data inferentially. The analysis's findings demonstrated a significant linear association ($\text{sig.} = 0.197$) between learning outcomes and digital information literacy. Digital information literacy and typical learning outcomes make up the residual distribution between the known variables ($\text{sig. } 0.076 > 0.05$). With an F

value of 3.96, regression analysis demonstrates a substantial influence of digital information literacy on learning outcomes (sig. = 0.05).

Saini, S. (2023) studied Relevance of Digital Information Literacy in Library Management: A Study, the author explored the impact of digital literacy abilities on library operations and services, as well as the importance of digital information literacy in library management. The Author used a mixed-methods approach for his study to collect data from the users and the staff members experiences and their skills in digital literacy through surveys and interviews. According to the findings of this study, digital information literacy abilities are critical for efficient library management because they let staff members offer better services, encourage user participation, and make digital resources easier to access. To maintain their future relevance in the digital age, the study's conclusion advises libraries to provide staff and user training in digital information literacy top priority.

Kori, D. (2023) investigated evaluation of information literacy skills and competencies among Post Graduate mathematics students: a study, the author discussed about the ability to locate, evaluate, organize, and convey information in a variety of formats is known as information literacy. This ability is especially useful when making decisions, solving problems, or gaining knowledge. These studies of information literacy in all of its forms highlight the topic's novelty as well as how important it is to people from all walks of life, both in and out of the classroom. To evaluate students' knowledge, it is essential to evaluate their competencies and information abilities. The educational outcomes of students who acquire the requisite information literacy abilities are enhanced. The assessment of information literacy abilities among Post Graduate mathematics students at Mangalore University is the focus of this study. It found a few programs in information literacy that were essential for improving Post Graduate (PG) students' research abilities. There were sixty graduate students studying mathematics in the study population. The purpose of the study was to evaluate the information literacy competencies and skills of Post Graduate mathematics students at Mangalore University in Mangalore.

Deepmala, S., Sharma, S., & Upadhyay, A. K. (2022) reviewed in the article Digital Information Literacy that the “Digital literacy ensures that ideas and contemporary platforms be used thoughtfully and for educational, personal, and professional goals”. Digital literacy illustrates the relationship with other information abilities. It also involves applying relevant information in various platforms utilizing a range of techniques, such as desktops, and managing affairs appropriately in the virtual age through the use of technology tools,

communication channels, and internet services. By providing digital education, librarians may assist students in enhancing their data learning. The authors of this article discussed the utilization of webpages, URLs, and websites to locate and retrieve content on the internet.

Abdoh, E. S. (2022) investigated online health information seeking and digital health literacy among information and learning resources undergraduate students, the author adopted a simultaneous exploratory mixed methods strategy to investigate the main objective. Thirty-six students were invited to complete an online survey, and seventeen students took part in phone interviews. Both quantitative (SPSS) and qualitative (NVivo 10) techniques were used to examine the gathered data. The respondents most frequently used YouTube, social media, and search engines to find information about COVID-19. The most frequently searched subjects among the respondents were COVID-19 symptoms, limits, and the current COVID-19 outbreak. The digital health literacy subscales of "adding self-generated content" and "information search" showed notable and pertinent variations. On the other hand, there were no appreciable variations in the "determining relevance" subscale of digital health literacy.

Sofyan, D. (2022) conducted a study on online reading materials to improve reading capacity of the students of national university of Battambang of Cambodia, fifty students were participated in this mixed-methods study. The participants in the quantitative analysis were asked to respond to 63 items on a questionnaire that had four possible answers: strongly agree, agree, disagree, and disagree strongly. To gather qualitative data, 10 respondents were also required to reply to 21 interview questions. The findings of the author in this study showed that the students felt that consuming online reading material was beneficial. But they also ran into problems like a bad internet connection, unsuitable electronics, problems with screen brightness, an inability to buy devices that would support online reading, difficulty using proper terms when searching for topics, a lack of reading strategies, problems with eyesight, and privacy and security concerns. Through the use of online reading materials, this study helped students to acquire important knowledge, improving their reading ability and meeting their learning target.

Lohia, P., & Madhusudhan, M. (2021) studied that students use their smartphones to browse the Internet in search of knowledge and information. This article identified that the students of the University of Delhi acquire knowledge by utilizing their smartphones to access a wide range of content on the Internet; hence, it helps to understand how to utilize cell phones to obtain information. The main purpose of this study is to ascertain how LIS students utilize

smartphones to access digital information resources. As per this study's findings, the majority of students own and use smartphones. Nearly the majority of the respondents consult digital information resources on their smartphone's multiple times a day. This study uses of smartphones for enhancing digital information literacy skills, despite the main drawbacks of smartphones, such as their short battery life, poor memory, small screen keys, and potential for abrupt obsolescence, their widespread use and instant accessibility have a significant impact on LIS students' access to information. According to the study, the top three benefits of using a smartphone are its availability around the clock, rapid access to information, and instant information sharing.

Li, J., Brar, A., & Roihan, N. (2021) identified the Usage of digital technology to Enhance Language and Literacy Skills for Indigenous People: A Systematic Literature Review, they reviewed Indigenous people have consistently performed below average academically when compared to non-Indigenous groups because of the detrimental intergenerational effects of colonization and financial duress. Due of this, Indigenous people have been unable to complete their high school education and pursue chances for post-secondary education and employment. The acquisition of the necessary language and literacy abilities for success in both the workplace and school is one of their biggest obstacles. This study, therefore, investigates the evidence supporting the effectiveness of employing digital technology to promote Indigenous people's acquisition of language and literacy abilities through a systematic review of 25 empirical research.

Aziz, N. A. (2021) investigated smartphone usage among university students, the number of people using smartphones has risen to over 2.5 billion, and by 2020, and it is expected to reach five billion. Extended use of a smartphone suggests a fixation with virtual reality. Students from secondary school to tertiary education were among the smartphone users, and their ongoing use of these devices raises concerns about addiction, which could have a detrimental effect on academic performance. In order to investigate problematic smartphone use, hours spent, reasons, and activities engaged, as well as to discuss the potential risks of phone addiction among Malaysian university students, the current study was conducted. The author used a descriptive research design to gather data, and descriptive statistics including mean, standard deviation, frequency, and percentage were used to analyse the data. In this study, the survey was completed by fifty-five out of eighty students at a public university. According to this data, the majority of them said in part that they used their smartphones for no good purpose at all every hour and that it helped them feel more emotionally stable. The results of this suggested

that although the students did not use their smartphones for academic objectives, they were in some ways, smartphone addicts. The results of this study should aid higher education institutions in better comprehending the usage patterns of smartphones among college students as well as in minimizing or managing academically disruptive smartphone addiction behaviours.

Maharaj, G., Kanadia, P., & Tandel, R. (2021) conducted research into investigate digital information literacy among the faculty members of Gujarat Adani Institute of Medical Sciences, aims to investigate and explore the faculty's perceptions of digital information literacy (DIL) as well as their abilities and competencies when accessing digital information at Gujarat's GAIMS. This study has helped to set a standard for academic library professionals to project and outline the digital literacy plan according to the requirements of the institution. It has also provided information on the various types of DIL skills and capabilities required for Faculty members of ICT, constraints affecting related skills, and competencies. The authors of the article also suggested some suitable measures to meet the challenges in GAIMS and they said that the librarian must be permitted with the necessary DL abilities and intense competencies to accomplish the primary purpose of meeting users' information demands in the library.

More, A. (2021) investigated information literacy among graduate students in Dodamarg, took a survey to analyse the skills of digital information literacy among undergraduate students in the arts and commerce faculties at Laxmibai Sitaram Halbe College, Dodamarg. The author of this study Ramkisan A. More, also examines issues like awareness of digital resources, their intended use, how often they are used, etc. Data of this study was gathered via an online Google quiz, which was used by the researcher as part of the survey procedure. Additionally, a significant portion of students (61.3%) use the internet to read e-newspapers, whereas just 12.9% utilize it to browse e-books. Additionally, this article discovered that the majority of respondents 98.4% of students only knew about the Google search engine.

Verma, M. K., Nisha, F., & Shukla, R. (2021) conducted a study on assessment of digital information literacy skills among the library and information science students of the university of Delhi, attempt to evaluate the University of Delhi's library and information science students' proficiency with digital information literacy. It had been determined that the survey approach is appropriate for carrying out the study, in which 80 structured questionnaires were randomly distributed among DLIS students, and 72 (90%) of the questionnaires were returned by the respondents. Following questionnaire analysis, it was discovered that 57 students, or 79.17%

of the total, reported using a computer daily and being conversant with MS Office applications. All of the students, 66 (91.67%) of whom were using the Internet daily, were fully aware of the need to have Internet literacy skills. A significant portion of students, 69 (56.1%), used the basic search method, while the largest number of students, 69 (65.71%), used their mobile data to access the Internet.

Joel, A. P. (2021) studied on digital competencies needed by librarians and information professionals for knowledge management of 21st century university libraries in Borno state, the study identified the digital capabilities information workers and librarians require to manage the knowledge of 21st-century university libraries in Borno State. The study was directed by three research questions. A descriptive survey research design was used for this investigation. The study's participants included fifty-nine officially registered librarians working in Borno State's university libraries. The researcher deemed the population size to be manageable, hence the entire community was included in the study. Questionnaires are used as the data collection tool. The "Questionnaire on Digital Competencies for Knowledge Management" (QDCKM) was the name of the grading scale. Three clusters were created within the instrument. The tool was trial tested among ten library professionals at Ahmadu Bello University, which is not included in the study but has features in common with the research region, and was face-verified by two experts. The instrument's internal consistency was assessed using Cronbach Alpha. For the three clusters, an overall co-efficient value of 0.72 was determined. To address the study concerns, the mean standard deviation of the data was analysed. The results showed that knowledge management of 21st-century libraries in Borno State requires a high level of information technology abilities, interpersonal competencies, and leadership competencies from librarians and information professionals. Since libraries and information professionals have been in the business of discovering knowledge, collaborating and sharing knowledge, gathering, filtering, and analysing knowledge, it was recommended, among other things, that they combine their resources to raise awareness of the concepts of knowledge management in libraries.

Oyeniya, J. (2020) investigated evaluation of the availability, accessibility and usage of electronic resources in university library, the author discussed the recent technological advancements in information technology (IT) that have led to the rise of information resources becoming a worldwide phenomenon. Utilizing digital information in learning is one example of the extensive changes that these information technology advancements have brought about in the higher education sector. This study investigates how students use electronic resources in

university libraries, including their accessibility, availability, and use. The study included a randomized sampling technique to pick 535 students from two colleges. A questionnaire was utilized to collect data, which was then evaluated using percentages and tables. According to the data, all students use electronic resources, but only a small percentage of them visit the university library's collection. Additionally, most students are unaware of the library's online resources existence and the fact that they are not always readily available. The library must raise awareness among students and the university community regarding the availability, usability, and existence of its electronic resources.

Kalorth, N., Verma, M., & Sagar, M. (2020) studied information and user among social media literacy in digital societies, they described that how the social media networks have been closely monitoring and discussing the flow of information in digital societies for more than ten years. According to this study users may now satisfy their daily information needs digitally thanks to the move from conventional modes of communication to social media. In order to comprehend how a user and a network of users interact with information, this article expands on narrative analysis of a subset of active social media users and their digital social engagement. To ascertain the function of social media literacy, this study conducted user interviews and compared the results with recently published social media literature. The findings of this article indicate that social media literacy is becoming a crucial component of the information system, but it only affects small-scale communities that are situated at the nexus of online and offline domains.

Mardani, P. B., & Silalahi, R. R. (2020) investigated the digital information literacy skill level on college student (Case: Final-Year College Student), the authors analysed the skill level of DIL among college students. The findings of this study could help colleges better prepare their students for high-quality research by helping them with their digital information literacy. The author used a descriptive quantitative methodology for the study to make use of SCONUL's (Standing Conference of National and University Libraries) Seven Pillars of Information Literacy. The results of this survey show how highly proficient the students are at using digital information. They can determine the information needed based on their research topic and conduct keyword searches to find relevant material.

Lokesha, & Kumari, H. (2019) took a survey on the Digital Information Literacy of Mangalore University Students. This study discussed that digital information resources are becoming a necessary tool for all students. Without the digital information resources, the studying would be unthinkable. That is the nature of their relationship. The author of this study

examines the goals, techniques, searching, accessibility, issues, characteristics, and kinds of digital information resources available at Mangalore University.

Lokesha, & Kumari, H. (2019) took a survey on the Digital Information Literacy of Mangalore University Students. This study discussed that digital information resources are becoming a necessary tool for all students. Without the digital information resources, the studying would be unthinkable. That is the nature of their relationship. The author of this study examines the goals, techniques, searching, accessibility, issues, characteristics, and kinds of digital information resources available at Mangalore University.

Daniel, O. C. (2018), investigated the influence of computer literacy and online searching, the author looked to improve simple access to and use of academic materials in university libraries for higher productivity, computer literacy and online searching abilities are now essential due to the Web's exponential growth in information resources. Research Design: A survey was used in this study. Data for the study were gathered via a questionnaire, which was then administered using simple random sampling techniques and analysed using a descriptive statistical method. The results showed that 88% of the respondents had formal computer and IT instruction, which is primarily how they became computer literate. They are also adept with Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint. Furthermore, the survey reveals that most students do not search for academic information online using Boolean reasoning. The main obstacles include the library's outdated computer system, poor access speed, and inconsistent Internet access. According to the report, university libraries should offer appropriate instruction on how to conduct effective online searches, reliable Internet access, and a sufficient computer system.

Mishra, C. (2018) explored Faculty Perceptions of Digital Information Literacy (DIL) at an Indian University. The major goal of this study is to learn more about how faculty members at an Indian university perceive digital information literacy (DIL) and their own abilities and capabilities in using the digital information literacy. Sambalpur University (SU) in the state of Odisha had received particular attention in this investigation. This study had also shed light on the different DIL skills and competencies needed by information communication technology faculty members, as well as the limitations that affect these abilities and competencies. It also proposed appropriate solutions to address issues in university libraries. The author of this study had given information workers guidance on how to use evidence-based techniques and creative

solutions to address the needs and desires of university faculty members' information requirements.

Yahaya, A. (2018), discussed the topic of challenges of managing electronic information resources in federal university libraries in the north west, Nigeria. In this study, the author looked at the difficulties in managing electronic information resources (EIRs) at federal university libraries in Nigeria's north-western region. The study employed a narrative research design and qualitative research approach to gather participant data. The study population consisted of ten (10) participants who were specifically selected from the five federal university libraries located within the study area. Focus group interviews served as the primary technique of data collection, while the thematic qualitative data analysis method was employed for analysis. As per the study's findings, the university libraries under investigation host and manage a variety of electronic resources, including electronic databases, theses and dissertations, manuscripts, conference/seminar proceedings, e-books, and e-journals. The study also discovered that low funding, a lack of policy guidelines, a lack of user education, a lack of continuous training, unstable power supplies, slow speed networks caused by low bandwidth that affect internet connectivity, a lack of well-trained personnel with knowledge of the science of managing technological equipment, and poor funding are all contributing factors to the low level of EIRs. According to the report, managing EIRs effectively and efficiently will require advanced ICTs, which will undoubtedly improve accessibility and utilization. Additionally, trained and competent staff members should work as e-librarians, with ongoing training and retraining programs in place to enable them to offer library users efficient and high-quality service.

Abhinandan, & Yellinje, S. (2018), conducted a study on information literacy among lecturers in colleges at mangalore university colleges, looked at the information literacy abilities of instructors in undergrad institutions affiliated with Mangalore University in Karnataka. The research employed a descriptive survey approach, and a random sample selection process was used. For the study, 100 questionnaires were obtained. The data was analyzed using a basic statistical program that used frequency counts and percentages. The study discovered that some of the lecturers at Mangalore University had the following information literacy skills: the capacity to use information effectively to complete a task; the capacity to recognize the needed information; the capacity to access the needed information effectively and efficiently; and the capacity to critically evaluate information.

K.R.Mulla. (2018) studied on use and usage patterns of social networking sites among library professionals in graduate colleges of Bangalore city, the author investigated the use of social media and social networking sites in higher education libraries is discussed in the article, along with consumption trends. This paper aims to investigate the social media usage of higher education institutions' users and ascertain the level of awareness regarding social media among these institutions' librarians. The paradigm of social media has helped librarians develop some of their most effective practices and has facilitated the dissemination of knowledge to end users. The findings indicate that social media is commonly utilized to spread information among users and build institutional reputation. Social media sites and applications are also becoming more significant in the Indian context.

Kumari, K., & Mallaiah. (2017) investigated digital information literacy skills among faculty members of engineering colleges in Mangalore, Karnataka: a study, focused on the methods and techniques used by faculty members to look for information from various digital information sources. Additionally, this study identified the usage of digital information sources that faculty members use to obtain knowledge relevant to their respective fields. The main purpose of the article is the resources utilized to familiarize oneself with the subject or subjects. This study will undoubtedly aid in the planning of various information literacy initiatives at the college to advance faculty development of information literacy abilities and enhance the calibre of instruction.

M, Lokesha. (2017) studied on the use and awareness of social networking tools by the research scholars of Mangalore University: a study, the author investigated that one of the most interesting developments of this decade has been the emergence of online social networks. Communities of people who are interested in learning about the interests and activities of others or who share their own interests and activities are known as online social networks. This essay primarily focuses on how Mangalore University research academics use and are aware of social media platforms. A large number of these social networks provide incredibly rich content and data. This article also aims to investigate why young people use social media. It focuses on the benefits and drawbacks of young people utilizing social media.

Patil, S. (2017), conducted a study on usage of online social networking services in university libraries: a study of university libraries of Karnataka, Social networking sites are now a very effective tool for library services. Online social networking services have been used by libraries

over time to increase user-friendliness and popularity of their services. Numerous applications available on social networking sites such as Facebook, YouTube, Twitter, LinkedIn, Google+, and Instagram can be leveraged by libraries to offer a range of services. Based on an analysis of 54 university websites in the state of Karnataka, the paper discusses the usage of social networking services in university libraries. A content analysis method has been used to examine the websites. According to the findings, 98.14%, or 53 out of 54 universities, do have their websites across several domains. 29.62% of State and Central colleges have a Facebook connection. 18.51% of universities have connections to various social media platforms. While the state's university libraries are keeping up with new technology, many of these services are only utilized for basic needs. According to the study's findings, university libraries should take advantage of the resources and make the most of these social networking sites.

Noh, Y. (2016) studied the effect of digital literacy on information use behaviour. This essay makes an effort to examine how much of an impact various categories and subgroups had on how people use information. Like with much earlier studies, a survey was used in this investigation. Targeting college students from five different universities, 221 surveys out of 250 were returned, yielding an 88.4% return rate. According to the findings, bit literacy had the greatest influence on how people use information, followed in order by technical literacy and virtual community literacy. Information use behaviour appears to have been most influenced by bit literacy, which is associated with the capacity to use information, including information search, information discernment, editing, processing, and utilization.

Viswanathan, & Sasireka. (2016), investigated the usage of library electronic resources among selected arts and science colleges in Tamil Nadu aims to address users' opinions about the use of library electronic resources in a few Tamil Nadu arts and science colleges. In this study, the author aims to determine how users of arts and science colleges perceive, use, and benefit from library resources. The primary source of information for analysis and interpretation is the questionnaire/interview method of data collection. A few recommendations for the efficient use of resources in scientific and arts college libraries are given in this study.

Sparks, R., Katz, R., & Beile, M. (2016) reviewed the framework and assessments with recommendations for next-generation assessment in this article *Assessing Digital Information Literacy in Higher Education*. The authors described that higher education institutions must be able to administer and use the findings of valid assessments of DIL to assess whether college graduates possess the necessary knowledge and abilities in DIL. In this article, they offered an

operational definition of DIL along with a thorough analysis of the definitions of this construct found in key frameworks from the workforce and higher education. The assessments that are available for measuring information literacy and associated characteristics are then reviewed, along with their features, construct alignment, and psychometric qualities (i.e., evidence of validity and reliability).

Waghchoure, S. S. (2016) studied the digital information literacy skills of library and information science professionals in Mumbai. During the academic year of 2015–16, the University of Mumbai sponsored the current effort as a Minor Research effort. The primary goal of the research finding out how digitally literate Mumbai-based library and information science professionals. There are 72 colleges in the greater Mumbai area under the University of Mumbai's administration. 21 distinct faculties make up the college. Every college librarian in the greater Mumbai area received a questionnaire. Out of all the responses from the colleges, the researcher had 48 (66.66%). Here is a full discussion of all the results.

ANJIAH. (2016) studied digital information literacy among research scholars and students community at Dravidian University, Kuppam-Andra Pradesh (India), the author demonstrated that 62 (63.26%) of the responders were men. The bulk of respondents, 62 (63.28%), have tablets, smartphones, laptops, and PCs. 47 (47.95%) of the professional respondents made use of the internet in the majority. Most respondents (102/81.60%) were aware of digital information; the bulk of respondents (66,67.34%) were from villages, followed by respondents (19.38%) from manuals. It's encouraging to us that the majority of respondents, 85 (86.73%), went to the library to check out e-books. Most of the respondents—92 (93.87%)—experience regular power outages, while 85 (88.77%) report having trouble connecting to the internet while using the hostel's digital resources.

Shopova, T. (2014) conducted a study on digital literacy of students and its improvement at the university, the author built a framework to improve the efficacy and efficiency of the learning process and to help students adapt to a labour market that is changing rapidly, students must enhance their digital competence and literacy level. To determine students' motivation for enhancing their digital literacy skills and enhance their academic performance, this paper includes an empirical component that examines and analyses the degree and mode of use of ICT by students in the learning process. This will help students succeed in society and not fall behind the constantly evolving demands of work and life.

Swamy, P. (2014) studied on usage of social networking sites by the students of management, Chennai, Tamil Nadu State, the author set out to find out how management students in Chennai, Tamil Nadu State, perceived and used social networking sites. Data were gathered from a representative sample of 472 students using structured questionnaires. According to the report, most students are aware of social networking sites and utilize them for casual conversation. Facebook surpassed Google+, Linked In, and Twitter as the most widely used and popular social networking platform. Many kids have been using social networking sites for more than five years, always using them to stay in touch with friends and family. While most of the students expressed dissatisfaction with social networking sites, they did say that social networking sites are highly helpful for libraries to access materials.

Lepp, A., Barkley, J. E., & Karpinski, A. C. (2013) investigated the relationship between cell phone use, academic performance, anxiety, and Satisfaction with Life in college students, the authors discussed that although the practical distinctions between modern mobile phones and desktop computers are becoming less evident, one distinction still stands out: cell phones are nearly always with users and enable access to a wide range of networks and services at any time or location. College students are the ones who adopt cell phones the quickest, according to the Pew Centre's Internet and American Life Project. New research indicates that frequent usage of cell phones may be negatively affecting students' behaviour and health. Therefore, we looked into the effects of texting (N = 490) and overall cell phone use (N = 496) on Satisfaction with Life (SWL) in a sizable sample of college students. It was predicted that anxiety and academic performance (GPA) would act as mediators in the relationship. There was a good overall fit between the texting and cell phone use models, according to two different path models. Texting and using a cell phone were strongly correlated with anxiety and negatively correlated with GPA; conversely, GPA and SWL were favourably and negatively correlated with anxiety and SWL, respectively. The discussion surrounding student cell phone use and its potential detrimental effects on mental health, academic achievement, and subjective well-being or happiness is furthered by this research.

CHAPTER 3
RESEARCH
METHODOLOGY

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1. Introduction

This Chapter deals with the methodology in the research that has been adopted for the study. The research methodology includes the significance of the study, the scope of the study, the hypothesis of the study, Research Design, Questionnaire and characterization.

3.2. Significance of the Study

The major purpose of the study is to measure the Digital Information Literacy Competencies among the Post Graduate students of National College Tiruchirappalli.

3.3. Statement of the Problem

To identify the Digital Information Literacy Competencies among the Post Graduate students of National College Tiruchirappalli.

3.4. Scope of the Study

The Study includes only Post Graduate Students of National College Tiruchirappalli.

3.5. Objectives of the Study

- To evaluate the Current Level of Digital Information Literacy
- To examine the Factors Influencing Digital Information Literacy
- To analyse the Relationship Between Digital Information Literacy and Academic Performance
- To propose Recommendations for Enhancing Digital Information Literacy
- To explore the Role of Social Media in Information Literacy

3.6. Hypotheses

The following hypotheses are formulated basis of content and coverage of framed objectives are they are tested by using appropriate statistical tools.

- There is significant association between Gender and Time spend for using digital devices
- There is significant association between Gender and Usage of Digital Devices
- There is significant association between Year of study and Usage of Browser
- There is significant association between Field of study and Usage of social

3.7. Method of Data Collection

A Survey with structured questionnaire method has been adopted for the present study. The study consists of totally nineteen questions divided into three major parts. Part I deals with Demographic details, Part II and Part III deals with the activities of digital information literacy by National College Students. The Questions are multiple choices. The questionnaires were

distributed via Google form to the students of National College Tiruchirappalli from which 132 responses were received by the students.

3.8. Universe of study

The universe of study comprises Post Graduate students of the National College, Tiruchirappalli

3.9. Sampling

National College Tiruchirappalli is selected for the present study. There are 400+ Post Graduate students in National College Tiruchirappalli. The researcher selected respondents based on the users (Post Graduate Students) of Resource Centre, National College Tiruchirappalli. Structured Google form questionnaire is shared among the Post Graduate users of Resource centre using the QR Code Link. Thus 132 responds are collected and used for the present study.

3.10. Tool

Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS) is used for Statistical Analysis. In this research Chi-square test and cross tabulation are used for the analysis of data.

3.11. Chapterization of the Study

Chapter I - Introduction

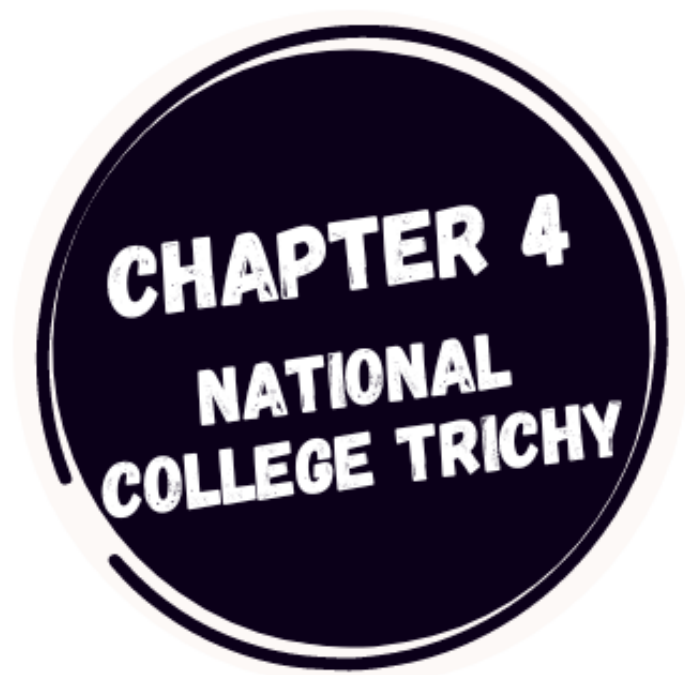
Chapter II – Review of Literature

Chapter III – Research Methodology

Chapter IV – National College Tiruchirappalli

Chapter V – Analysis and Interpretation

Chapter VI – Findings and Conclusion / Appendix



NATIONAL COLLEGE TIRUCHIRAPPALLI

4. INTRODUCTION

National College, Tiruchirappalli is one of the prestigious institutes; located in Tiruchirappalli, Tamil Nadu. Established in 1919, It was recognized as the 'College with Potential for Excellence' by the University Grants Commission in 2011. It has been re-accredited by NAAC with an A+ Grade (CGPA 3.61 out of 4.00 scale) College with Potential of Excellence.

Vision of the College

To offer quality Higher Education to the younger generations, especially from rural India, who are economically and socially backward, to liberate themselves from prejudice, oppression and ignorance and to gain knowledge for their bright future

Mission of the College

To ignite the young minds with lofty ideals and inspire them to achieve excellence in the chosen field.

To facilitate individual growth of students, with accent on character building, through co-curricular and extra-curricular activities.

To encourage the students to take-up research and help them reach global standards.

To provide a congenial atmosphere to study and learn, with infrastructural facilities of the highest order.

To instill in the minds of the students, the sense of Nationalism and to train them in social awareness.

4.1. Academic Programs

The institute offers Degree courses with 23 Undergraduate and 16 Post Graduate programs. Quality education is provided through these programs in Full Time mode.

Students can pursue various courses such as M. Com, M.Sc., M.A., Ph.D., B.A., B. Com, B.Sc., and BBA in different streams including Accounting & Commerce, Science, Humanities & Social Sciences, Business & Management Studies, Teaching & Education.

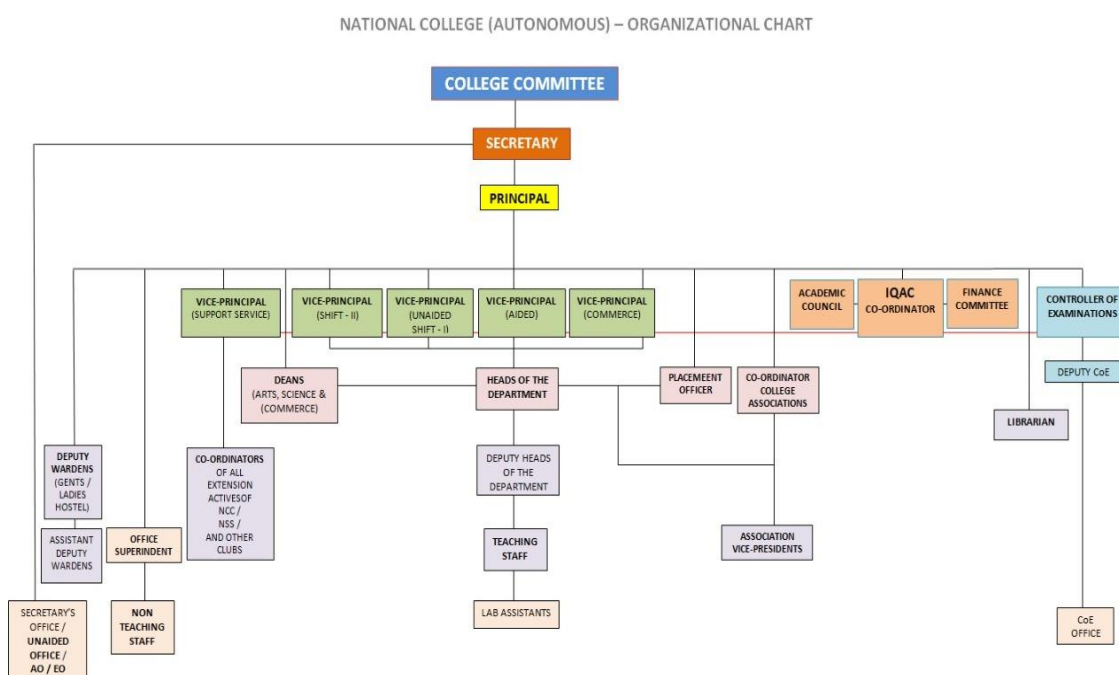
National College, Tiruchirappalli offers its students expertise gained through its trained and experienced faculty in the fields of Zoology, Biotechnology, Microbiology, Physics, Computer Science, Geophysics, Geology, Mathematics, Chemistry, Botany, and English.

National College, Tiruchirappalli provides good infrastructure facilities. Academic programmes include Tamil and English Literature, Hindi, Sanskrit, Geology, Mathematics,

Physics, Chemistry, Commerce, Management, Statistics, Economics, Philosophy, Botany, Zoology and History.

Facilities	
Undergraduate Programmes	23
Post Graduate Programmes	16
Students	4675
Teaching Staffs	274
Non-Teaching staff	73
PhD Qualified Staff	170
Major Projects (last 5 years)	7
Research Papers (last 5 years)	616
Workshops (last 5 years)	64

NATIONAL COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS) – ORGANIZATION CHART



Source: <https://www.nct.ac.in/about-library.html>

4.2.Resource Centre, National College Tiruchirappalli

About Library

The library of National College has a vibrant and long history. It started functioning on a modest scale in a Class Room, with just 470 books during the inception of the college in 1919.

Today, the nearly a century old library boasts of a vast collection of books on a wide range of subjects. The massive collection of about 1,25,000 volumes including very rare texts is the pride of National College. In addition, the library provides access to 105 nationals as well as international journals in print as well as online. In tune with the changing times and technology, the library automation programme was initiated in 2010 and networking with the Bharathidasan University Library has been completed.

In addition to the conventional sections such as Stacks, Reference, Circulation, Periodicals, Technical Section Thesis and Dissertation, the building houses a large Audio-Visual Theatre, spacious Conference Hall, E-Library, Librarian Chamber and Office. In short, the library is a communication centre backed by technology.

Acquisition & Technical Section

The A&T section takes care of the systematic compilation of requirements from the departments, Ordering of Books, Accessioning, Classification, Indexing and processing of books. It also develops a bibliographic database of books and other resources.

Circulation Section

Registration of membership, Issue of bar-coded ID cards, Issue and Receipt of books, Collection of dues, and No dues certification are handled by this section. The circulation process is fully automated with barcode technology and web-enabled OPAC.

Reference Section

The reference section contains general references like Dictionaries, Encyclopedias, Yearbooks, Directories, Gazetteers, Handbooks, Manuals etc., and subject reference books, books for competitive exams, Career development and personality development. The books are mainly meant for in-house academic reference. A separate collection of research-oriented books and books for civil services examinations are also maintained.

Periodical Section

It maintains 105 subscribed periodicals, of which 100 are national and 5 are international. The current research information can be accessed through these resources and apart from this; more than 5000 e-journals can be accessed on-line through UGC – NLIST.

Thesis Section

A collection of 607 Ph.D. Thesis, 2800 M.Phil. Dissertation and 3740 PG Projects are organized and made accessible to the research scholars. Subject wise List of thesis is readily available with the section in-charge for reference.

Stack Room

The Stack room located at the ground floor facilitates safe custody of valuable books. The stack has been well organized, maintained and arranged using latest edition of Dewey decimal classification for easy retrieval.

The library functions between 6.00 am to 8.00 pm on all working days of the college

Library General Rules

- All students of the college are members of the library.
- Strict silence should be maintained in the library
- All the students / scholars and outsiders entering the library shall keep their bags and other belongings in the entrance
- Only papers and library books to be returned are allowed inside the library
- Do not leave any valuables in the Personnel belongings section.
- The library is not responsible for any loss of personal belongings
- Identity card is compulsory for getting access to the library. This should be presented in the electronic gate register during entry and exit
- Beverages and eatables are not allowed inside the library
- Using Cell phones inside the library is strictly prohibited
- No photographs of the library shall be taken without proper authorization
- Demand and suggestion slips are available at the circulation desk for the users of the library
- Books/other material taken from the stacks should not be re-shelved by the readers. Books should be left on the reading table after use. (Please remember that a document misplaced is a document lost)
- The librarian reserves the right to suspend the membership of any member found misbehaving with the library staff or any other member

Students can make use of the Photocopying facility available in the general library. An exclusive Audio-Visual facility with internet connectivity is available in the library the students are exhorted to make the best use of the library.

- E-learning service
- E-Alert service
- Domain – Specific User Orientation
- Document Delivery Request
- Service on Request
- Multimedia Service
- E-Reference Desk
- Photocopying /scanning/printing Service
- Virtual Reference Library
- TNPSC Guide line classes
- Typewriting Classes
- Movie Screening Audio Visual Theatre
- Institutional Repositories (Digital versions of Rare Books & Question Papers)

LIBRARY STATISTICS	
1,19,214	Books(Prints)
110	Journals (Prints)
6525	Back volumes
32	Magazines
15	News papers
1,694	Theses
345	CD-ROM
N-List and DELNET	E-Resources
11293+	E-Journals
300000+	E-Books

CHAPTER 5
ANALYSIS &
INTERPRETATION

ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

Table-5.1

Distribution of Respondents by Gender

Gender	Frequency	Per cent
Male	77	58.3
Female	55	41.7
Total	132	100.0

Table-5.1 shows that 41.7% of respondents are female and 58.3% are male.

Figure: 5.1

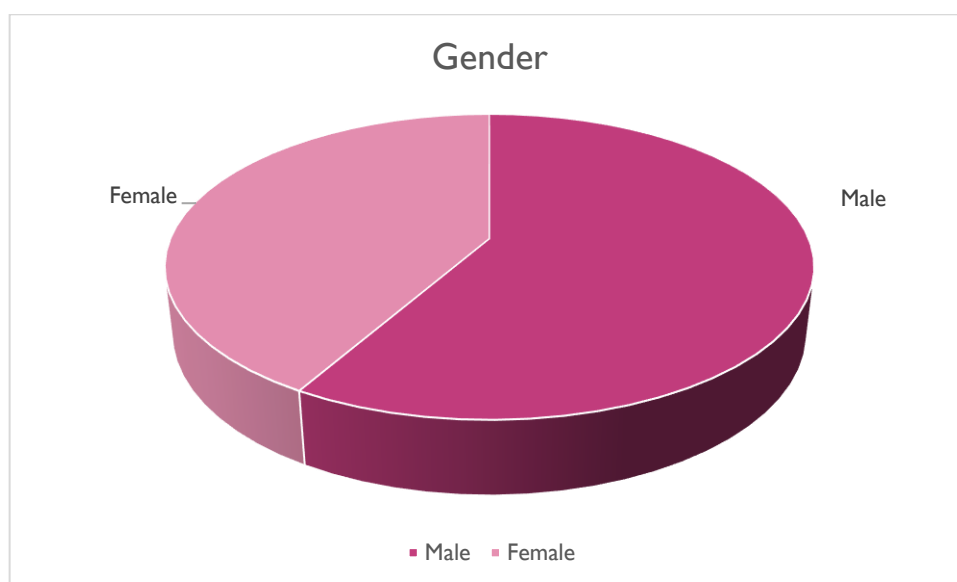


Table-5.2
Distribution of Respondents by Native Place

Native Place	Frequency	Per cent
Rural	77	58.3
Urban	34	25.8
Semi-Urban	21	15.9
Total	132	100.0

Table 5.2 shows that 58.3% of the respondents are from Rural, 25.8% are from Urban and 15.9% are from Semi-Urban.

Figure: 5.2

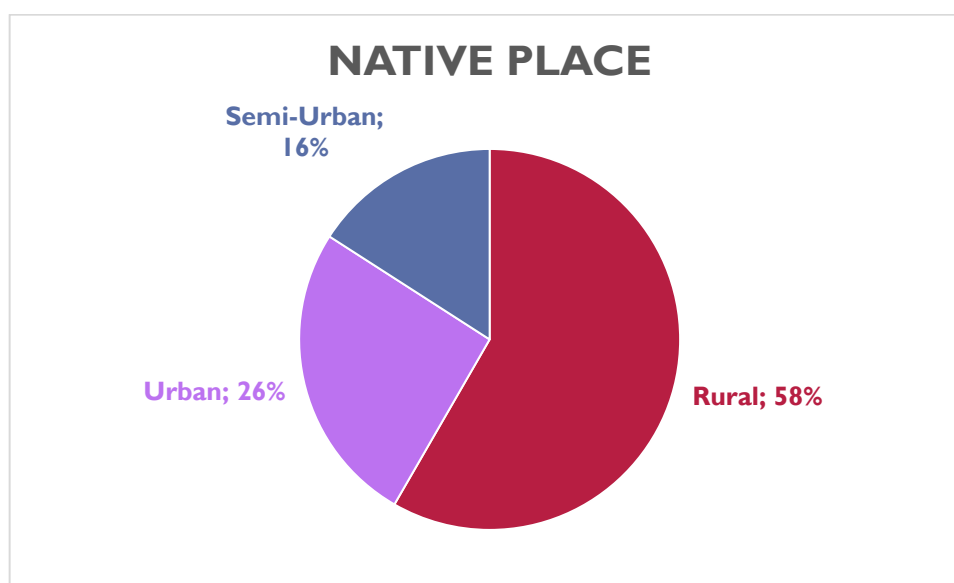


Table-5.3
Distribution of Respondents by Age

Age	Frequency	Per cent
21-23 years	27	20.5
24-26 years	94	71.2
27 and above	11	8.3
Total	132	100.0

Table 5.3 shows that 20.5% of the respondents are 21-23 years, 71.2% are 24-26 years and 8.3% are 27 and above.

Figure: 5.3

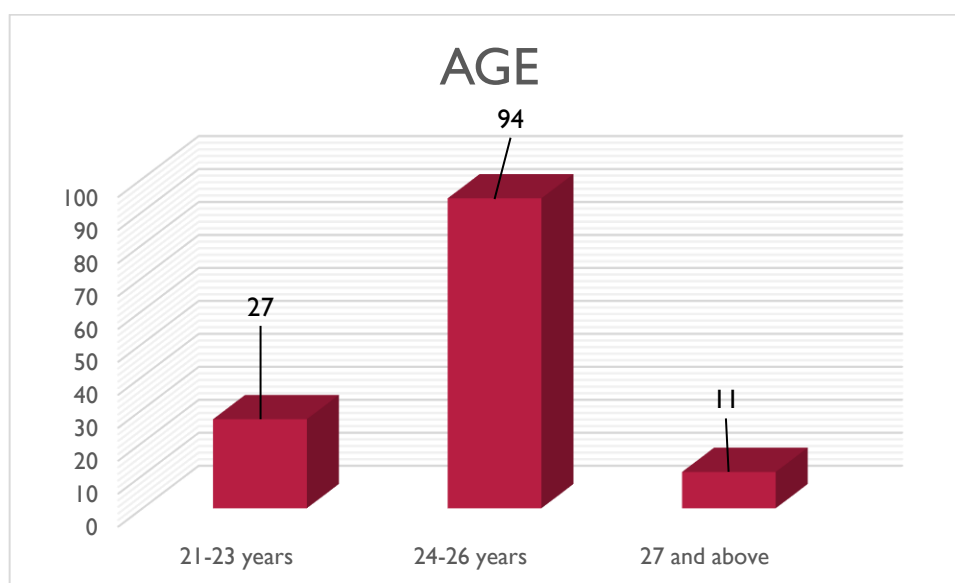


Table-5.4
Distribution of Respondents by Field of Study

Field of Study	Frequency	Per cent
Arts	37	28.0
Life Science	79	59.8
Humanities	16	12.1
Total	132	100.0

Table 5.4 shows that 28.0% of the respondents are Arts students, 59.8% are Life Science Students and 12.1% are Humanities.

Figure: 5.4

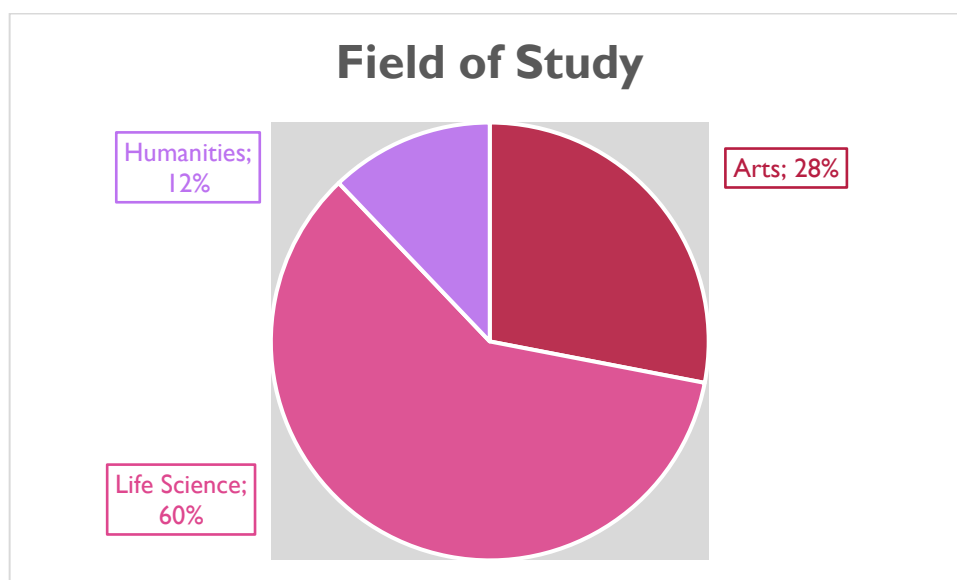


Table-5.5
Distribution of Respondents by Year of Study

Year of Study	Frequency	Per cent
I	55	41.7
II	77	58.3
Total	132	100.0

Table 5.5 shows that 41.7% of the respondents are I-year students and 58.3% are II-year students.

Figure: 5.5

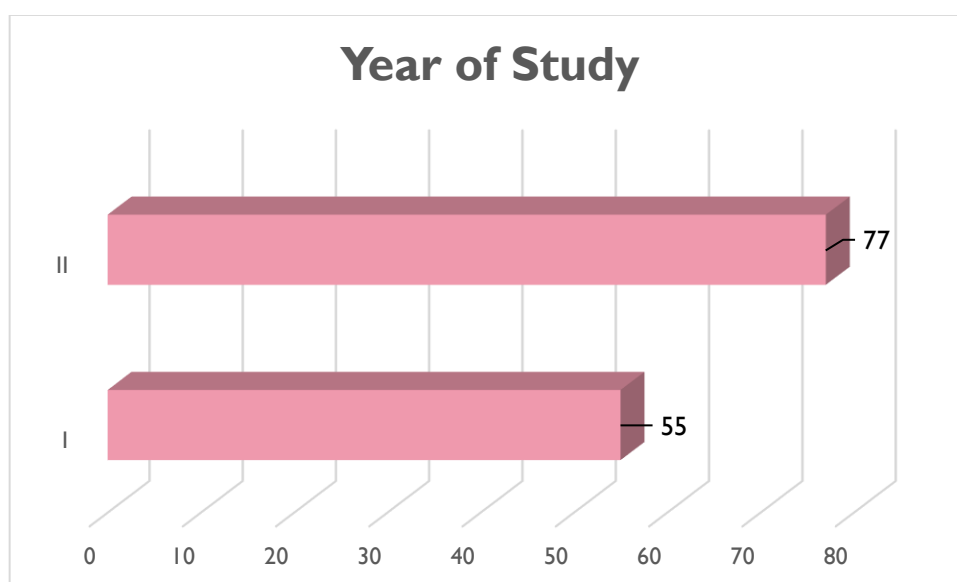


Table-5.6

Distribution of Respondents by Access of Digital resource for academic purpose

Access of Digital resource	Frequency	Per cent
Daily	80	60.6
Weekly	16	12.1
Twice a week	12	9.1
Thrice a week	10	7.6
As and when needed	14	10.6
Total	132	100.0

Table 5.6 shows that 60.6% of respondents access the digital resource daily for academic purposes, 12.1% of the respondents access the digital resources once a week for academic purposes, 9.1% twice a week, 7.6% thrice a week and 10.6% are accessing digital resources as and when needed.

Figure: 5.6

Access of Digital resource

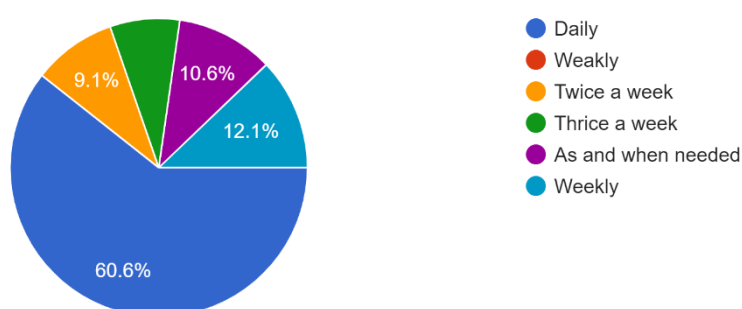


Table-5.7

Distribution of Respondents by Time Spend for Digital Devices

Time Spend for Digital Devices	Frequency	Per cent
1-2 hours	35	26.5
3-4 hours	36	27.3
5-6 hours	23	17.4
More than 6 hours	38	28.8
Total	132	100.0

Table 5.7 shows that 26.5% of the respondents spend 1-2 hours for using digital devices students, 27.3% spend 3-4 hours, 17.4% spend 5-6 hours and 28.8% of respondents spend more than 6 hours a day for using Digital Devices.

Figure: 5.7

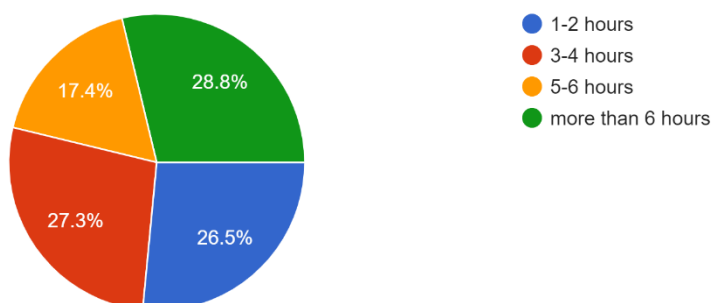


Table-5.8
Distribution of Respondents by Use of Digital Devices

Digital Devices	Never		Rarely		Sometimes		Often		Always	
	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P
Mobile Phone	1	0.8	6	4.5	17	12.9	19	14.4	89	67.4
Laptop	11	8.3	30	22.7	52	39.4	34	25.8	5	3.8
Tablet	68	51.5	32	24.2	23	17.4	8	6.1	1	0.8
Desktop Computers	23	17.4	39	29.4	36	27.3	26	19.7	8	6.1
Total	132					100.00				

Table 5.8 shows the distribution of digital device usage by the respondents. It found that 67.4% of respondents use Mobile Phone always, while 39.4% of respondents use laptops sometimes, 51.5% of respondents never use the tablet and 27.3% of respondents rarely use the Desktop Computers.

Figure: 5.8

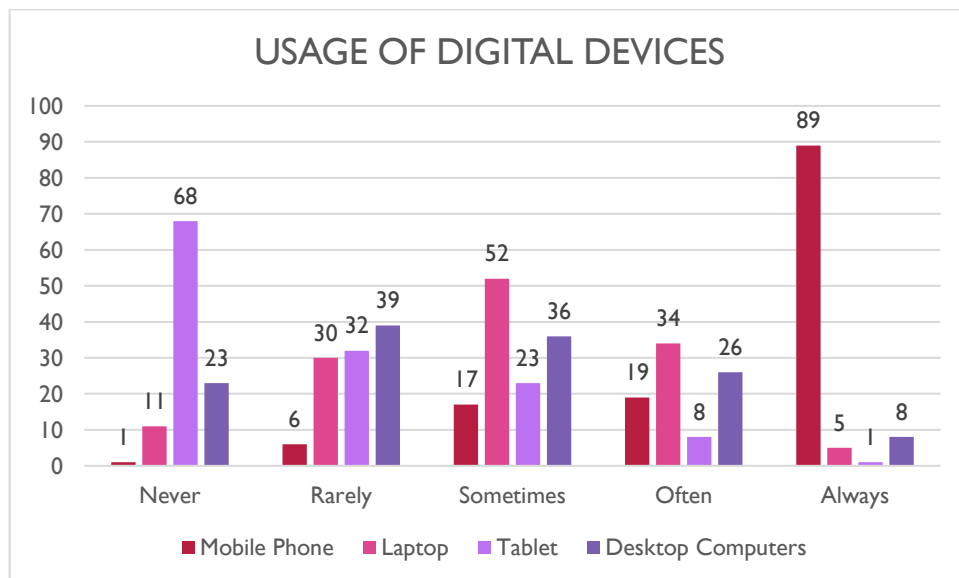


Table-5.9**Distribution of Respondents by Usage of Application Software**

Application Software	Not confident		Partially confident		Fully confident	
	F	P	F	P	F	P
Word Processor	13	9.8	65	49.2	54	40.9
Excel	23	17.4	79	59.8	30	22.7
PowerPoint	8	6.1	72	54.5	52	39.4
Image Editor	27	20.5	65	49.2	40	30.3
Video Editor	31	23.5	60	45.5	41	31.1
Total	132				100.0	

Table 5.9 shows that distribution of respondents by usage of application software. It found that 49.2% of respondents are fully confident with word processor, while 59.8% of respondents are partially confident with Excel, 54.5% of respondents are partially confident with PowerPoint. 49.2% of respondents are partially confident with Image Editor and 45.5% of respondents are partially confident with Video Editor.

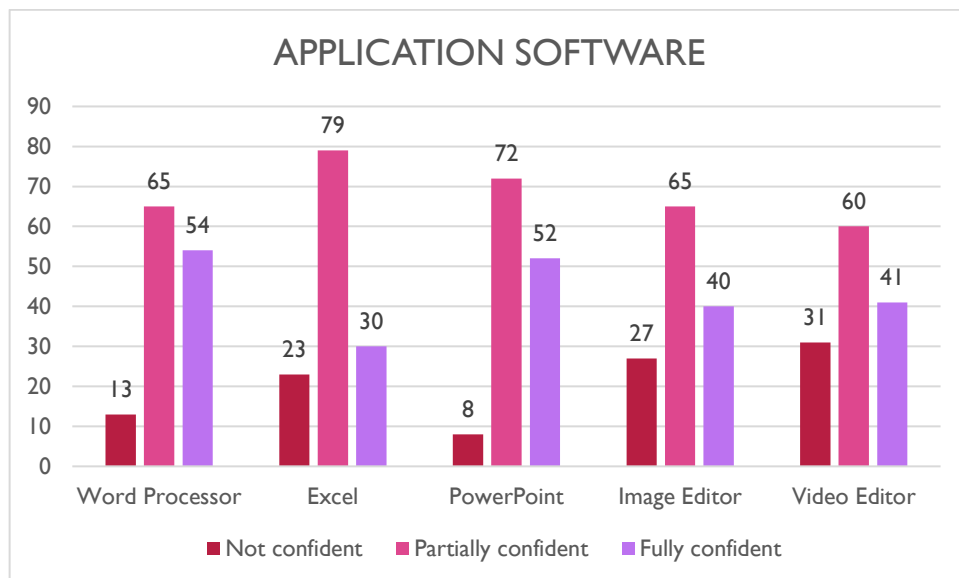
Figure: 5.9

Table-5.10**Distribution of Respondents by Interaction Online Activities**

Online Activities	Never		Rarely		Sometimes		Often		Always	
	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P
Social Media	2	1.5	6	4.5	15	11.4	22	16.7	87	65.9
Online Shopping	5	3.8	15	11.4	50	37.9	44	33.3	18	13.6
Academic Research	1	0.8	35	26.5	60	45.5	18	13.6	18	13.6
Online Learning	10	7.6	41	31.1	43	32.6	21	15.9	17	12.9
E-Mail	10	7.6	26	19.7	55	41.7	27	20.5	14	10.6
Total	132					100.0				

Table 5.10 shows the distribution of respondents by interaction online activities. It found that 65.9% of respondents use Social Media always, while 37.9% of respondents use Online Shopping for sometimes, 45.5% respondents use Academic Research for sometimes, 32.6% respondents use Online Learning for sometimes and 41.7% respondents use E-Mail for sometimes.

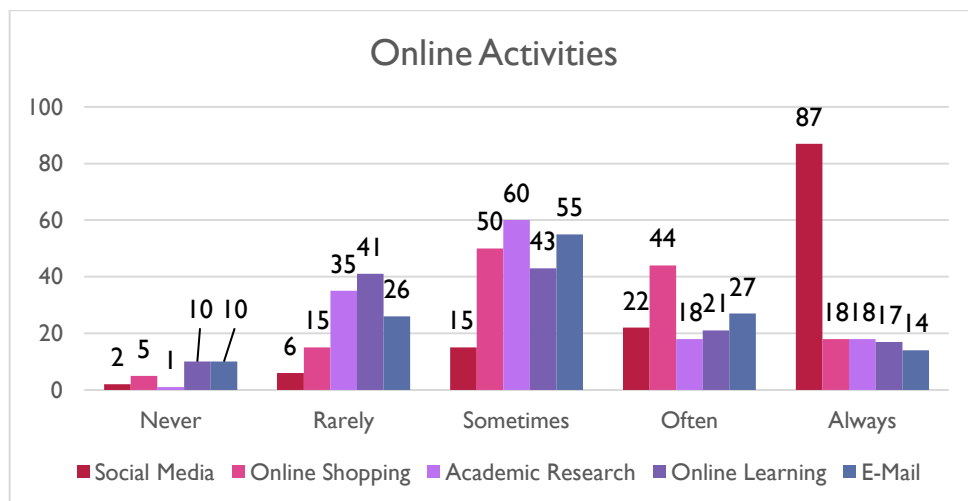
Figure: 5.10

Table-5.11

Distribution of Respondents by Usage of digital resources for academic purpose

Purposes	Never		Rarely		Sometimes		Often		Always	
	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P
Project Work	10	7.6	13	9.8	42	31.8	36	27.3	31	23.5
Research Article/Paper	11	8.3	32	24.2	57	43.2	26	19.7	6	4.5
Conference Paper	15	11.4	40	30.3	57	43.2	11	8.3	9	6.8
Writing Assignment	2	1.5	17	12.9	43	32.6	40	30.3	30	22.7
Total	132					100.0				

Table 5.11 shows the distribution of respondents by usage of digital resources for academic purpose. Found that 31.8% of respondents use digital devices for project work sometimes, while 43.2% of respondents use digital devices for Research Article/Paper for sometimes, 43.2% of respondents use digital devices for sometimes and 32.6% of respondents use digital devices for Writing Assignment for sometimes.

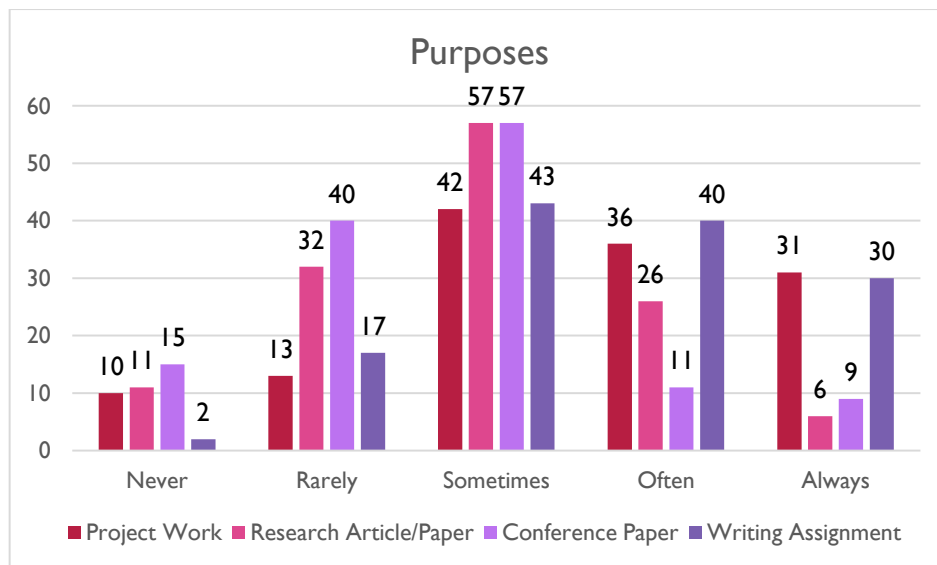
Figure: 5.11

Table-5.12

**Distribution of Respondents by Usage of Social Media Platform for
academic purpose**

Platform	Very Unfamiliar		Unfamiliar		Somewhat Familiar		Familiar		Very Familiar	
	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P
Facebook	15	11.4	16	12.1	13	9.8	52	39.4	36	27.3
Instagram	6	4.5	6	4.5	14	10.6	45	34.1	61	46.2
LinkedIn	12	9.1	10	7.6	28	21.2	51	38.6	31	23.5
YouTube	2	1.5	8	6.1	10	7.6	44	33.3	68	51.5
WhatsApp	3	2.3	5	3.8	13	9.8	43	32.6	68	51.5
X(Twitter)	27	20.5	19	14.4	29	22.0	37	28.0	20	15.2
Total	132					100.0				

Table 5.12 shows the distribution of respondents by usage of social media platform for academic purpose. It found that 39.4% of respondents familiar with Facebook, 46.2% of respondents very familiar with Instagram, while 38.6% of respondents familiar with LinkedIn, 51.5% of respondents very familiar with YouTube, 51.5% of respondents very familiar with WhatsApp and 28.0% of respondents familiar with X (formerly known Twitter).

Figure: 5.12

Usage of Social Media Platform

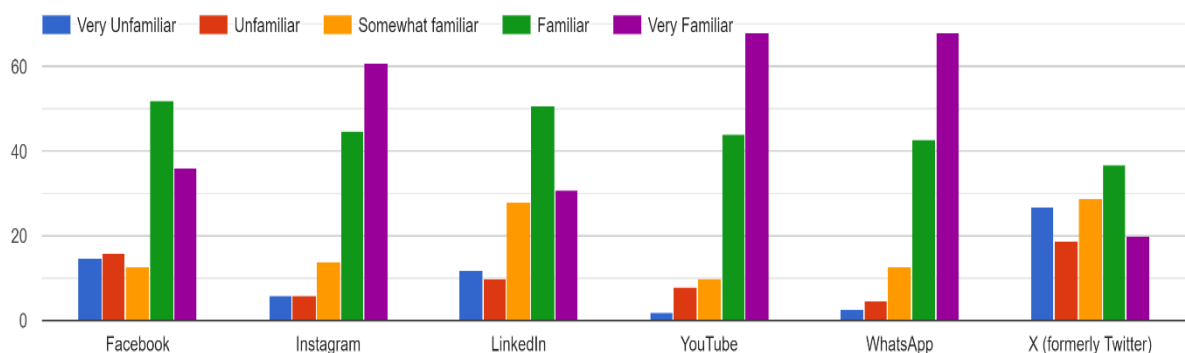


Table-5.13**Distribution of Respondents by Purpose of Using Social Media**

Purpose of Social media	Rarely		Sometimes		Always	
	F	P	F	P	F	P
Entertainment	6	4.5	59	44.7	67	50.8
Research	42	31.8	66	50.0	24	18.2
Communication	16	12.1	73	55.3	43	32.6
Update Knowledge	23	17.4	73	55.3	36	27.3
Collaborative research activities	64	48.5	44	33.3	24	18.2
Total	132				100.0	

Table 5.13 shows the distribution of respondents by purpose of using social media. It found that 50.8% of respondents use social media for entertainment always, while 50% of respondents use Social media for Research Sometimes, 55.3% of respondents use social media for Communication & Update Knowledge Sometimes and 48.3% of respondents use Social media for Collaborative research activities Rarely.

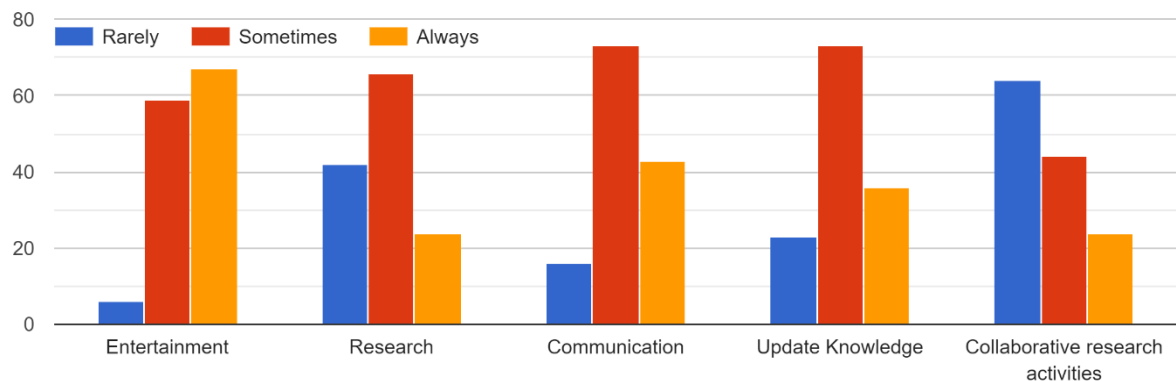
Figure: 5.13**Purpose of Using Social media**

Table-5.14**Distribution of Respondents by Usage of ASNS for research purposes**

Sites	Very Unfamiliar		Unfamiliar		Somewhat Familiar		Familiar		Very Familiar	
	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P	F	P
Google Scholar	8	6.1	12	9.1	11	8.3	61	46.2	40	30.3
Academia.edu	11	8.3	14	10.6	37	28.0	54	40.9	16	12.1
ResearchGate	18	13.6	33	25.0	33	25.0	31	23.5	17	12.9
Science Open	55	41.7	33	25.0	20	15.2	13	9.8	11	8.3
ScienceDirect	46	34.8	39	29.5	20	15.2	14	10.6	13	9.8
Total	132					100.0				

Table 5.14 shows the distribution of respondents by usage of ASNS for research purposes. 46.2% of respondents were familiar with Google Scholar, 40.9% of respondents familiar with academia.edu, 25% of respondents somewhat familiar with ResearchGate, 41.7% of respondents very unfamiliar with Science Open and 34.8% of respondents very unfamiliar with ScienceDirect.

Interpretation: In order to do research for their papers, postgraduate students need to be aware of academic social networking sites such as Science Direct, Science Open, and Research Gate. They have to consequently be aware of those ASNS.

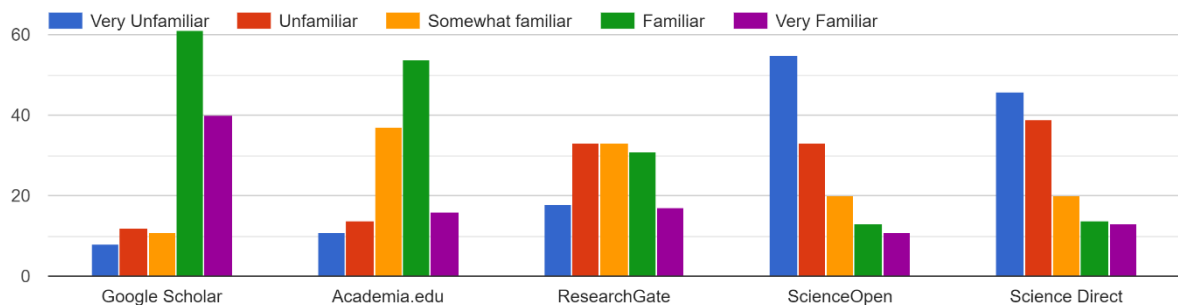
Figure: 5.14**Usage of ASNS for research purposes**

Table-5.15
Distribution of Respondents by Usage of Search Strategies

Search Strategies	Rarely		Sometimes		Always	
	F	P	F	P	F	P
Keyword/Heading Search	10	7.6	72	54.5	50	37.9
Boolean Operators (AND, OR, NOT)	49	37.1	68	51.5	15	11.4
Any Word/Basic Search	16	12.1	58	43.9	58	43.9
Phrase Search	44	33.3	67	50.8	21	15.9
Total	132				100.0	

Table 5.15 shows the distribution of respondents by usage of search strategies. It found that 43.9% of respondents use any word/basic search as a search strategy for always for locating online content, while 54.5% of respondents use keyword search strategy for sometimes, 51.5% of respondents use Boolean operators as search strategy for sometimes and 50.8% of respondents use phrase search for sometimes for locating online content.

Interpretation: Research researchers and postgraduate students need to be aware of the Phrase Search approach and Boolean operators such as AND, OR, and NOT operators while looking for material for their academic work.

Figure: 5.15
Usage of Search Strategies

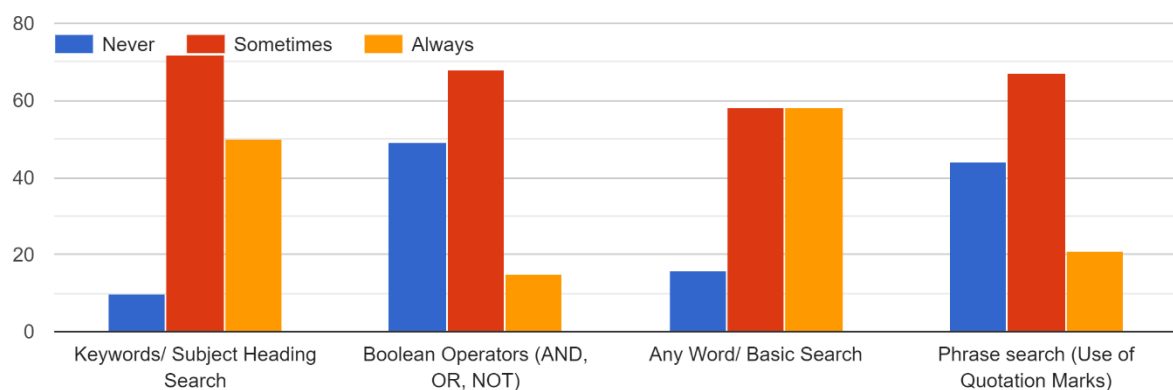


Table-5.16**Distribution of Respondents by Source helpfulness in learning to use Digital resources**

Source	Not at all helpful		Somewhat helpful		Most helpful	
	F	P	F	P	F	P
Friends	4	3.0	45	34.1	83	62.9
Classmate	5	3.8	77	58.3	50	37.9
Teachers	23	17.4	65	49.2	44	33.3
Library Staff	18	13.6	77	58.3	37	28.0
Self-Learning	10	7.6	49	37.1	73	55.3
Total	132				100.0	

Table 5.16 shows the distribution of respondents by source helpfulness in learning to use digital resources. It found that most helpful source for learning how to use digital resources, according to 62.9% of respondents, is friends while classmates (58.3%), teachers (40.2%), library staff (58.3%), and self-learning (55.3%).

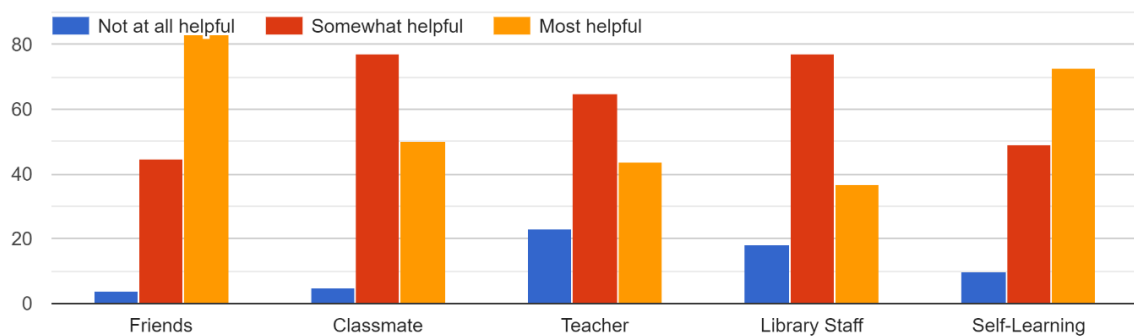
Figure: 5.16**Source helpfulness in learning to use Digital resource**

Table-5.17
Distribution of Respondents by Usage of Browser

Browser	Rarely		Sometimes		Always	
	F	P	F	P	F	P
Google	2	1.5	24	18.2	106	80.3
Microsoft Edge	23	56.8	42	31.8	15	11.4
Opera	68	51.5	45	34.1	19	14.4
Internet Explorer	70	53.0	44	33.3	18	13.6
Mozilla Firefox	26	19.7	81	61.4	25	18.9
Total	132				100.0	

Table 5.17 shows the distribution of respondents by usage of browser. It found that 80.3% of respondents use Google browser always, while 56.8% of respondents use Microsoft Edge browser rarely, 51.5% of respondents use Opera browser rarely, 53% of respondents use Internet Explorer rarely and 61.4% of respondents use Mozilla Firefox sometimes.

Figure: 5.17
Usage of Browser

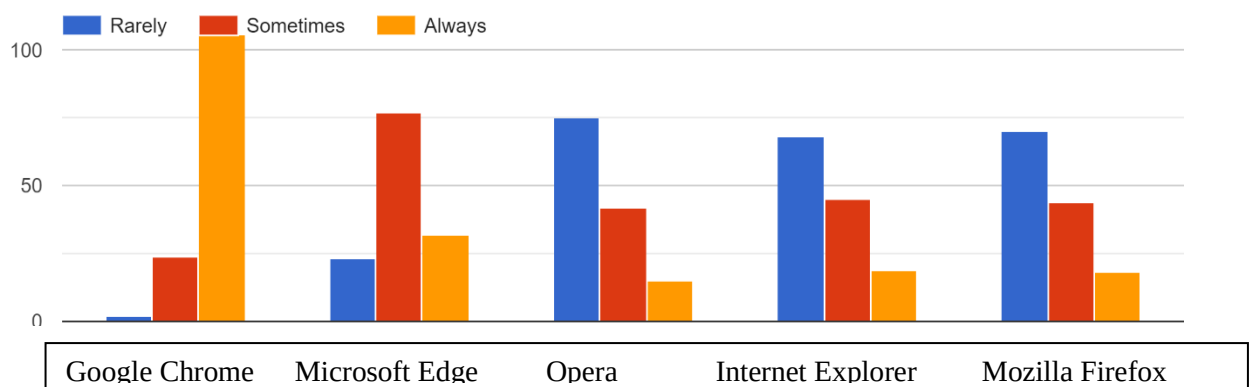


Table-5.18

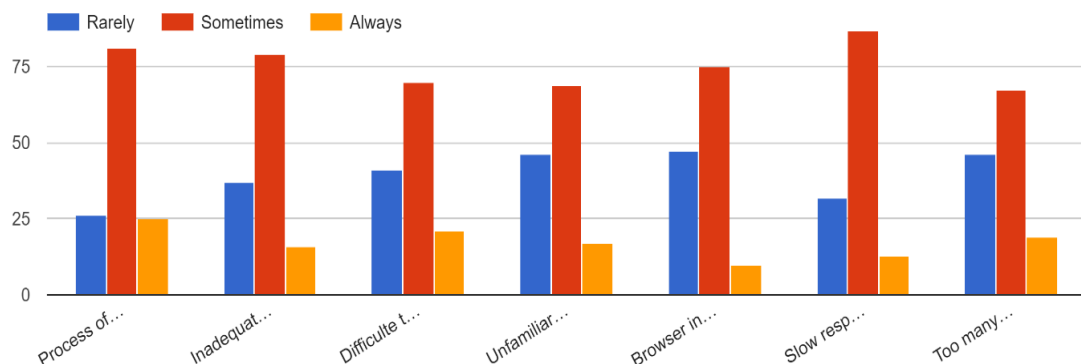
Distribution of Respondents by Problems Faced While Accessing Digital Resources

Problems	Rarely		Sometimes		Always	
	F	P	F	P	F	P
Process of login	26	19.7	81	61.4	25	18.9
Inadequate/unfamiliar Search Features	37	28.0	79	59.8	16	12.1
difficulties to download, save & print	41	31.1	70	53.0	21	15.9
Unfamiliar Content layout	46	34.8	69	52.3	17	12.9
Browser inadequate	47	35.6	75	56.8	10	7.6
Slow response	32	24.2	87	65.9	13	9.8
Too many results/ inadequate features to sort results	46	34.8	67	50.8	19	14.4
Total	132				100.0	

Table 5.18 shows the distribution of respondents by problems faced while accessing digital resources. It found that 61.4% of respondents have problems in the process of login sometimes, while 59.8% of respondents have inadequate search features sometimes, while 53% of respondents have difficulties downloading, saving and printing sometimes, 52.3% of respondents unfamiliar with content layout as a problem sometimes, 56.8% of respondents have browser inadequate as a problem sometimes, 65.9% of respondents have slow response as a problem sometimes and 50.8% of respondents have too many results as a problem sometimes.

Figure: 5.18

Problems Faced While Accessing Digital Resources



HYPOTHESIS – I

There is significant association between Gender and Time spend for using digital devices

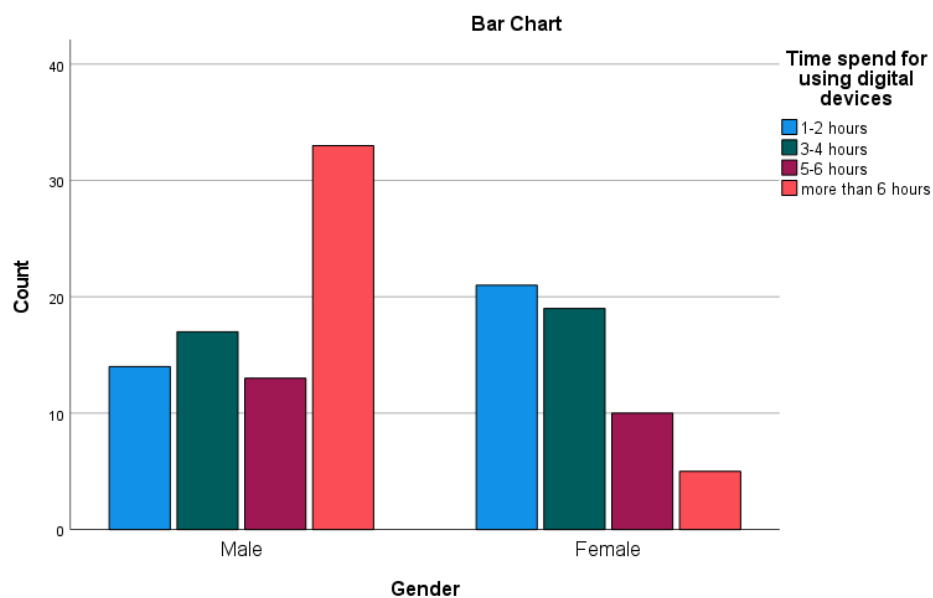
Table-5.19

Chi-square test between Gender and Time spend for using digital devices

Gender	1-2 hours	3-4 hours	5-6 hours	More than 6 hours	Total	Statistical Interference
Male	14	17	13	33	77	$X^2=19.406$
Female	21	19	10	5	55	df=3
Total	35	36	23	38	132	P=0.001 P<0.005 Significant

The above table shows that there is significant association between the gender and the time spent for using digital devices. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is accepted.

Figure: 5.19



HYPOTHESIS – II

There is significant association between Gender and Usage of Digital Devices

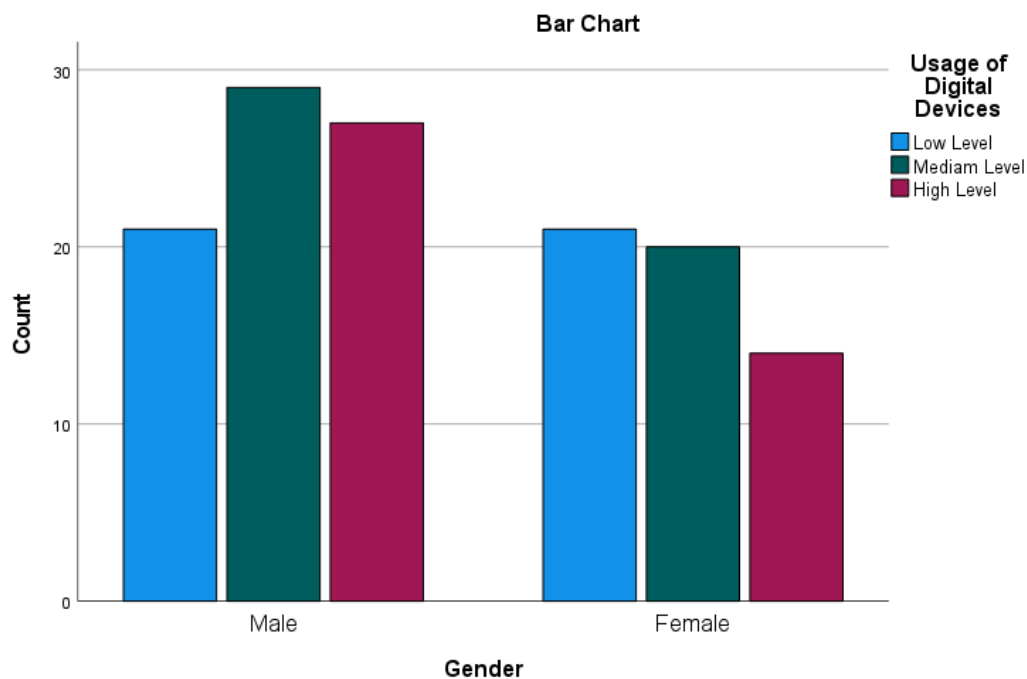
Table-5.19

Crosstabulation between Gender and Usage of Digital Devices

Gender	Low level	Medium level	High level	Total	Statistical Interference
Male	21	29	27	77	$X^2=2.169$
Female	21	20	14	55	$df=2$ $P=0.338$
Total	42	49	41	132	$P>0.005$ Not Significant

The above table shows that there is not significant association between the Gender of the respondents and the level of usage of digital devices. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is rejected.

Figure: 5.20



HYPOTHESIS – III

There is significant association between Year of study and Usage of Browser

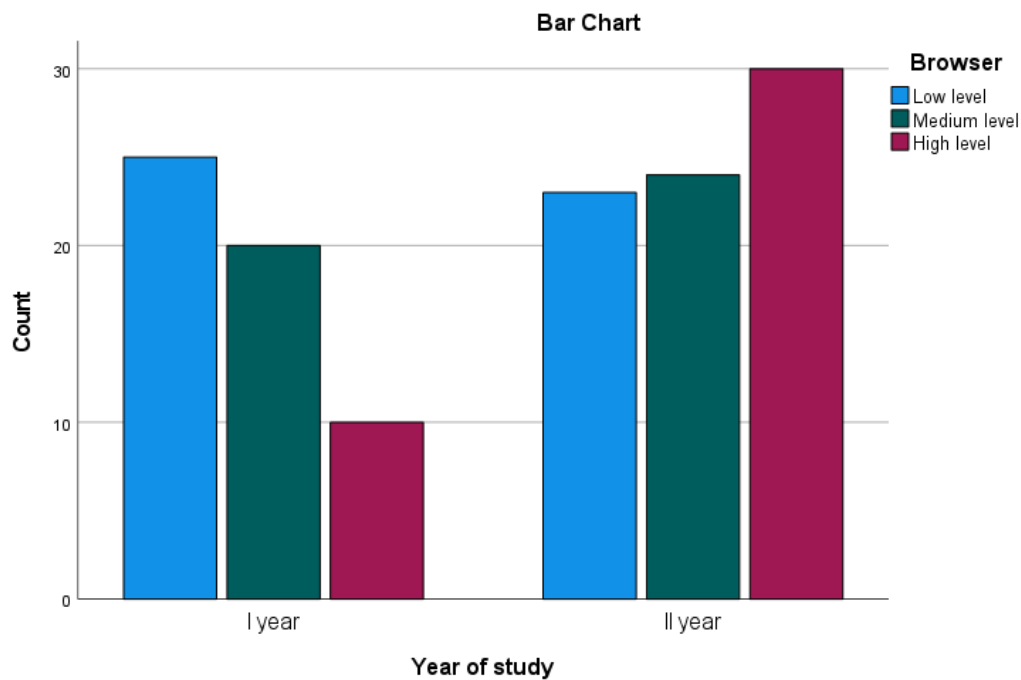
Table-5.20

Crosstabulation between Year of study and Browser

Year of study	Low level	Medium level	High level	Total	Statistical Interference
I Year	25	20	10	55	$X^2=6.974$
II Year	23	24	30	77	$df=2$ $P=0.031$
Total	48	44	40	132	$P>0.005$ Not Significant

The above table shows that there is not significant association between the Year of study of the respondents and the level of usage of Browsers. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is rejected.

Figure: 5.20



HYPOTHESIS – IV

There is significant association between field of study and usage of social media

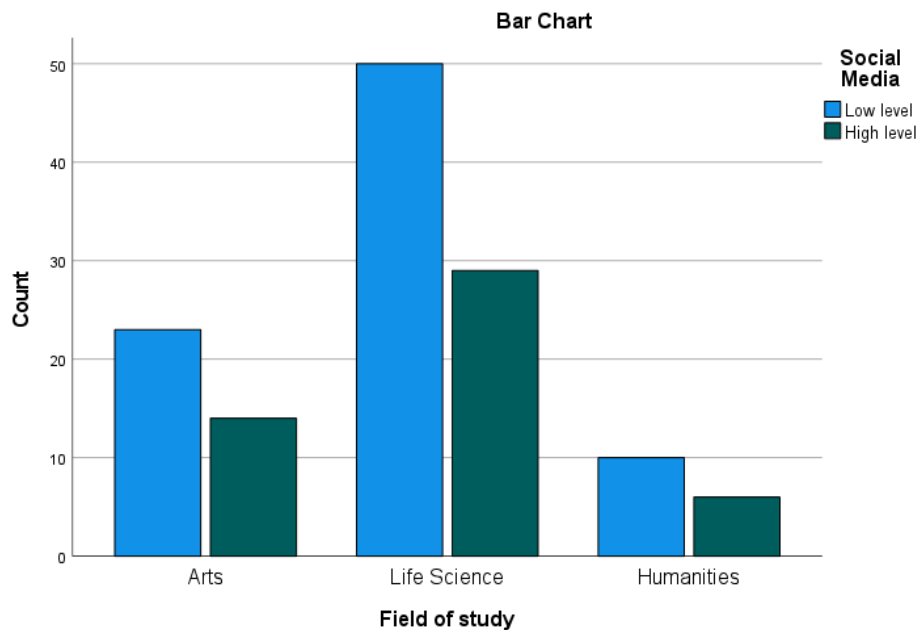
Table-5.21

Crosstabulation between Field of study and Usage of social media

Field of study	Low level	High level	Total	Statistical Interference
Arts	23	14	37	$\chi^2=0.015$
Life science	50	29	79	$df=2$
Humanities	10	6	16	$P=0.993$
Total	83	49	132	$P>0.005$ Not Significant

The above table shows that there is not significant association between the Field of study of the respondents and the level of usage of social media. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is rejected.

Figure: 5.21



CHAPTER 6
RESEARCH
FINDINGS &
CONCLUSION

RESEARCH FINDINGS

Demographic Findings

- 41.7% of respondents are female and 58.3% are male.
- 58.3% of the respondents are from Rural, 25.8% are from Urban and 15.9% are from Semi-Urban.
- 20.5% of the respondents are 21-23 years, 71.2% are 24-26 years and 8.3% are 27 and above.
- 28.0% of the respondents are Arts students, 59.8% are Life Science Students and 12.1% are Humanities.
- 41.7% of the respondents are I-year students and 58.3% are II-year students.

General Digital Information literacy skills Findings

- 60.6% of respondents access the digital resource daily for academic purposes, while 12.1% of the respondents access the digital resources once a week for academic purposes, 9.1% twice a week, 7.6% thrice a week and 10.6% are accessing digital resources as and when needed.
- 26.5% of the respondents spend 1-2 hours for using digital devices students, 27.3% spend 3-4 hours, 17.4% spend 5-6 hours and 28.8% of respondents spend more than 6 hours a day for using Digital Devices.
- 67.4% of respondents use Mobile Phone always, while 39.4% of respondents use laptops sometimes, 51.5% of respondents never use the tablet and 27.3% of respondents rarely use the Desktop Computers.
- 49.2% of respondents are fully confident with word processor, while 59.8% of respondents are partially confident with Excel, 54.5% of respondents are partially confident with PowerPoint. 49.2% of respondents are partially confident with Image Editor and 45.5% of respondents are partially confident with Video Editor.
- 65.9% of respondents use Social Media always, while 37.9% of respondents use Online Shopping for sometimes, 45.5% respondents use Academic Research for sometimes, 32.6% respondents use Online Learning for sometimes and 41.7% respondents use E-Mail for sometimes.

Academic Digital Information Literacy Usage Findings

- 31.8% of respondents use digital devices for project work sometimes, while 43.2% of respondents use digital devices for Research Article/Paper for sometimes, 43.2% of respondents use digital devices for sometimes and 32.6% of respondents use digital devices for Writing Assignment for sometimes.
- 39.4% of respondents familiar with Facebook, 46.2% of respondents very familiar with Instagram, while 38.6% of respondents familiar with LinkedIn, 51.5% of respondents very familiar with YouTube, 51.5% of respondents very familiar with WhatsApp and 28.0% of respondents familiar with X (formerly known Twitter).
- 50.8% of respondents use social media for entertainment always, while 50% of respondents use Social media for Research Sometimes, 55.3% of respondents use social media for Communication & Update Knowledge Sometimes and 48.3% of respondents use Social media for Collaborative research activities Rarely.
- 46.2% of respondents were familiar with Google Scholar, 40.9% of respondents familiar with academia.edu, 25% of respondents somewhat familiar with ResearchGate, 41.7% of respondents very unfamiliar with Science Open and 34.8% of respondents very unfamiliar with ScienceDirect.
- 43.9% of respondents use any word/basic search as a search strategy for always for locating online content, while 54.5% of respondents use keyword search strategy for sometimes, 51.5% of respondents use Boolean operators as search strategy for sometimes and 50.8% of respondents use phrase search for sometimes for locating online content.
- Most helpful source for learning how to use digital resources, according to 62.9% of respondents, is friends while classmates (58.3%), teachers (40.2%), library staff (58.3%), and self-learning (55.3%).
- 80.3% of respondents use Google browser always, while 56.8% of respondents use Microsoft Edge browser rarely, 51.5% of respondents use Opera browser rarely, 53% of respondents use Internet Explorer rarely and 61.4% of respondents use Mozilla Firefox sometimes.
- 61.4% of respondents have problems in the process of login sometimes, while 59.8% of respondents have inadequate search features sometimes, while 53% of respondents have difficulties downloading, saving and printing sometimes, 52.3% of respondents unfamiliar with content layout as a problem sometimes, 56.8% of respondents have browser inadequate as a problem sometimes, 65.9% of respondents have slow response

as a problem sometimes and 50.8% of respondents have too many results as a problem sometimes.

Findings of Hypotheses

- ❖ There is significant association between the gender and the time spent for using digital devices. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is accepted.
- ❖ There is not significant association between the Gender of the respondents and the level of usage of digital devices. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is rejected.
- ❖ There is not significant association between the Year of study of the respondents and the level of usage of Browsers. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is rejected.
- ❖ There is not significant association between the Field of study of the respondents and the level of usage of social media. Hence the alternative hypothesis for the above table is rejected.

Conclusion

The study of postgraduate students' digital information literacy competences emphasizes how vital it is to have sophisticated abilities for accessing, assessing, and using digital information resources. The research's conclusions highlight how urgently educational establishments must incorporate and give priority to programs that specifically address the opportunities and problems that postgraduate scholars face in the digital sphere.

Postgraduate students need to be prepared with the skills essential to succeed in their academic endeavours and make significant contributions to their subjects as the digital world continues to change. This study emphasizes the multifaceted character of digital information literacy, which includes critical thinking, ethical issues, effective communication, and technological skill.

Educators, institutions, and stakeholders must work together in order to guarantee that postgraduate students are adequately equipped to meet the needs of an increasingly digitalized academic and professional environment in the future. In the end, encouraging postgraduate students to be proficient in digital information literacy is an investment in the future of research and creativity.



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Further Studies

- Study the feasibility of Introducing Digital Information Literacy Programs for Post Graduate Students of College Affiliated to Bharathidasan University of Tiruchirappalli.
- Research on Digital Information Literacy competencies of faculty members will help us to understanding the level awareness and use of various ICT tools and online resources.



APPENDIX

Digital Information Literacy Competencies among Students of National College Trichy: A Study

Dear Friends,

I am C. Sivakumar doing II MLib.I.Sc in Bishop Heber College, Trichy. As part of my PG studies, I would like to undertake a project on "*Digital Information Literacy Competencies among students of National College Trichy : A Study*". In this regard, I have prepared a questionnaire and I would like to request you to kindly spare a few minutes of your valuable time to fill-in this questionnaire. Information shared by you will be confidential and used only for my MLib.I.Sc. research project. Permission has been obtained to carry out this research project.

Thanking you

Sincerely

(Sivakumar)

(Dr. Yesan. S)

II MLib.I.Sc

Project Guide & Assistant Professor

Bishop Heber College

sivakarthicksk22@gmail.com [Switch accounts](#)



Not shared

* Indicates required question

1. Gender *

☐ Male

☐ Female

2. Native place *

- ☐ Rural
- ☐ Urban
- ☐ Semi-Urban

3. Age *

- ☐ 21-23 years
- ☐ 24-26 years
- ☐ 27 and above

4. Field of Study *

- ☐ Arts
- ☐ Life Science
- ☐ Humanities

5. Year of Study *

- ☐ I year
- ☐ II year

Part B: General Digital Information literacy skills

(Tick appropriate answer)

6. How often do you access digital resources for your academic purposes? *

- ☐ Daily
- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Twice a week
- ☐ Thrice a week
- ☐ As and when needed

7. **Digital Device Usage:** On average, how many hours per day do you spend time for using digital devices (e.g., laptop, smartphone, and tablet)? *

- ☐ 1-2 hours
- ☐ 3-4 hours
- ☐ 5-6 hours
- ☐ more than 6 hours

8. How often do you use the following digital device? *

	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
Mobile Phone	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Laptop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Tablet	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Desktop Computers	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

9. How proficient are you in creating and editing digital documents in using the following *
application software? Level of confidence

	Not Confident	Partially Confident	fully Confident
Word Processor	☐	☐	☐
Excel	☐	☐	☐
PowerPoint	☐	☐	☐
Image editor	☐	☐	☐
Video editor	☐	☐	☐

10. Among the following online activities rate your interaction with regard to your frequency of use.

	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
Social Media	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Online Shopping	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Academic Research	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Online Learning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
E-Mail	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Part C: Academic Digital Information literacy Usage

(Tick appropriate answer)

11. How often do you use digital resources for the following academic purposes? *

	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
Project Work	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Research Article/ Paper	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Conference Paper presentation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Writing Assignment	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

12. How skilled are you in using social media platforms for academic purposes? *

	Very Unfamiliar	Unfamiliar	Somewhat familiar	Familiar	Very Familiar
Facebook	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Instagram	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
LinkedIn	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
YouTube	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
WhatsApp	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
X (formerly Twitter)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

13. For what purpose do you use the social media in above mentioned platforms? *

	Rarely	Sometimes	Always
Entertainment	☐	☐	☐
Research	☐	☐	☐
Communication	☐	☐	☐
Update Knowledge	☐	☐	☐
Collaborative research activities	☐	☐	☐

14. Among the following academic social networking sites, how familiar are you in using ^{*} them for research purposes?

	Very Unfamiliar	Unfamiliar	Somewhat familiar	Familiar	Very Familiar
Google Scholar	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Academia.edu	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ResearchGate	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
ScienceOpen	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Science Direct	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

15. How often do you use the following search strategies to locate information in ^{*} online/digital resources?

	Never	Sometimes	Always
Keywords/ Subject Heading Search	☐	☐	☐
Boolean Operators (AND, OR, NOT)	☐	☐	☐
Any Word/ Basic Search	☐	☐	☐
Phrase search (Use of Quotation Marks)	☐	☐	☐

16. Rate the following sources helpfulness in learning to use digital resources. *

	Not at all helpful	Somewhat helpful	Most helpful
Friends	☐	☐	☐
Classmate	☐	☐	☐
Teacher	☐	☐	☐
Library Staff	☐	☐	☐
Self-Learning	☐	☐	☐

17. Among the following browsers, how familiar are you in using them? *

	Rarely	Sometimes	Always
Google	☐	☐	☐
Microsoft Edge	☐	☐	☐
Opera	☐	☐	☐
Internet Explorer	☐	☐	☐
Mozilla Firefox	☐	☐	☐

18. Problems faced while accessing digital resources and its frequency. *

	Rarely	Sometimes	Always
Process of login	☐	☐	☐
Inadequate / unfamiliar Search features	☐	☐	☐
Difficult to download, save & print	☐	☐	☐
Unfamiliar Content layout	☐	☐	☐
Browser inadequate	☐	☐	☐
Slow response	☐	☐	☐
Too many results/ inadequate features to sort results	☐	☐	☐

19. Suggestion if any

Your answer

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